

NEXACORE

TECHNOLOGIES

Employee Handbook

Official Governance Document — Human Resources

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This handbook supersedes all previous versions of the NexaCore Technologies Employee Handbook. Where this handbook and a specialised policy document differ, the specialised policy document prevails.

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Revision History

The Employee Handbook is a controlled document. All changes are version-controlled, recorded below, and published to the HRMS (Workday) document library. Employees are notified of every major revision by email from the Employee Success (HRBP) team. Only the version published on the HRMS is considered authoritative; printed or locally saved copies are treated as uncontrolled copies.

Table FM-1: Revision History of the NexaCore Employee Handbook

Version	Date	Summary of Changes	Author	Approver
1.0	01 Apr 2022	First release of the consolidated Employee Handbook. Established company overview, organisation structure, working hours, attendance and dress code sections. Replaced the legacy "New Joiner Guide".	Employee Success (HRBP) Team	Ritika Sharma, CHRO
2.0	01 Apr 2023	Added Section 9 (Technology at NexaCore) covering HRMS, Slack, GitHub Enterprise, Jira and Confluence. Introduced the job grade table for L1-L6 and C1. Formalised the 6-month probation period for Full-Time Employees.	Employee Success (HRBP) Team	Ritika Sharma, CHRO
2.1	12 Sep 2023	Interim update. Revised the visitor pre-registration requirement to 24 hours in advance via the Envoy app. Added the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) as the first point of contact for POSH matters.	Facilities & Workspace Management	Amit Verma, Facilities Manager
3.0	01 Apr 2024	Introduced the hybrid working model (up to 2 days per week from home for eligible L2+ employees post-probation) and the one-time WFH Setup Allowance of ₹15,000. Added the Escalation Matrix. Expanded the Health & Safety section.	Employee Success (HRBP) Team	Arjun Mehta, CEO
3.2	15 Oct 2025	Updated the Role-Based Laptop Specifications table following the hardware refresh programme. Added the Northern Regional Hub at Cyber Heights, Patiala, Punjab to the office locations table. Clarified the late-coming deduction rule at 10:30 AM.	IT Support & Asset Management	Priya Nair, CTO
4.0	01 Apr 2026	Annual review and full re-issue for Financial Year 2026-27. Published the 2026 Holiday Calendar. Added Section 14 (Frequently Asked Questions). Added the Promotion Matrix with salary bands and minimum tenure requirements. Restructured Section 13 as a signpost to the eight core governance documents. Added glossary cross-references throughout for search and retrieval.	Employee Success (HRBP) Team	Arjun Mehta, CEO

NOTE: The next scheduled review of this handbook is **31 March 2027**. Employees who identify an error, an ambiguity or an out-of-date reference should raise a "Document Feedback — Employee Handbook" ticket in the HRMS, addressed to the Employee Success (HRBP) team. Out-of-cycle corrections are issued as point releases (for example, 4.1) and are recorded in this table.

Document Control

Purpose

The purpose of the NexaCore Technologies Employee Handbook is to provide every employee, intern and contractor with a single, authoritative reference describing how the company operates on a day-to-day basis. It explains what NexaCore expects from the people who work here, and equally what those people can expect from NexaCore in return. The handbook consolidates the practical, operational rules that govern working hours, attendance, office access, conduct, learning, technology and employee support so that a new joiner can become productive quickly and an existing employee can find a definitive answer without escalating to a colleague or a manager.

This handbook is deliberately written as an operational guide rather than a legal contract. It summarises and signposts the specialised governance documents — the Leave Policy, the Expense & Reimbursement Policy, the Information Security Policy, the Employee Benefits Guide, the Remote Work Policy, the Code of Conduct and the Travel Policy — without replacing them. Where a topic is governed in depth by one of those documents, this handbook explains the essentials and directs the reader to the controlling document for complete details.

Scope

This handbook covers the internal working practices of NexaCore Technologies across all four office locations: the Global Headquarters at TechPark One, Bengaluru, Karnataka; the Northern Regional Hub at Cyber Heights, Patiala, Punjab; the Western Delivery Center at IT Space, Pune, Maharashtra; and the Southern R&D Center at Innovation Tower, Hyderabad, Telangana. It applies to work performed on company premises, at client sites, while travelling on company business, and while working from home under an approved hybrid arrangement.

This handbook does **not** cover: individual terms of compensation (set out in your offer letter and appointment letter); client-specific delivery processes (documented on Confluence by the relevant delivery team); statutory filings and corporate governance (managed by the Legal & Compliance Team and Finance); or technical engineering standards (maintained by Engineering & IT on GitHub Enterprise and Confluence).

Applicability

Table FM-2: Applicability of the Employee Handbook by Employee Category

Category	Grades	Extent of Applicability
Full-Time Employees (FTE)	L2 - L6	Fully applicable. All sections, including probation, hybrid work eligibility, promotion, benefits, learning budgets and the full leave entitlement, apply.
Interns / Trainees	L1	Applicable with stated exceptions. Interns work 100% from the office, receive pro-rated leave, are not covered under corporate health insurance, and have a 15-day notice period. Sections on conduct, attendance, security, safety and office information apply in full.
Consultants / Contractors	C1	Applicable with stated exceptions. Contractors follow all conduct, attendance, security, safety and office rules. They do not accrue Casual, Earned or Sick Leave, are not covered under corporate insurance, and have a 30-day notice period. Commercial terms are governed by the individual contract of engagement.

Audience

- **New employees** — read Sections 1 to 6 before Day 1 and the whole handbook within the first two weeks. The Frequently Asked Questions in Section 14 answer most first-month queries.
- **Existing employees** — use this handbook as a reference for attendance, dress code, facilities, escalation and the annual holiday calendar.
- **Managers (L4 and above)** — you are accountable for applying these rules consistently within your team, approving attendance corrections and leave, recommending promotions and acting as the first point of contact for general grievances.
- **Human Resources** — the Employee Success (HRBP), Talent Acquisition and Payroll & Benefits teams own the processes described in Sections 3, 5, 8 and 10.
- **Leadership (L5 and L6)** — leadership approves policy exceptions, international travel, out-of-policy expenses and promotions to Director grade and above.

Definitions

The following abbreviations are used throughout this handbook. A complete company glossary is maintained in the NexaCore Knowledge Base on Confluence.

Table FM-3: Key Definitions Used in This Handbook

Term	Definition
BGV	Background Verification. The mandatory credential and criminal check process, administered by HireRight.
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer. Currently Ananya Rao.
CL	Casual Leave. Time off for personal matters; lapses at year-end.
CTC	Cost to Company. The total gross salary package including base, bonuses and benefits.
EL	Earned Leave. Accrued paid time off; up to 10 days can be carried forward.
F&F	Full and Final Settlement. The final payroll calculation upon an employee's exit.
FTE	Full-Time Employee. Grades L2 through L6.
GMC	Group Medical Cover. The corporate health insurance policy.
GPA	Group Personal Accident. Insurance covering disability or accidental death.
GTL	Group Term Life. Life insurance providing 3x Annual CTC to the nominee.
HRMS	Human Resources Management System. The internal portal for leaves, payroll and performance (Workday).
ICC	Internal Complaints Committee. The governing body that handles POSH grievances.
LWD	Last Working Day. The final date of employment after serving the notice period.
MDM	Mobile Device Management. Security software installed on all company-owned hardware.
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan. A 60-day corrective action plan for employees with an "Unacceptable" rating.
POSH	Prevention of Sexual Harassment. The legal framework and company policy ensuring a safe workplace.
SL	Sick Leave. Time off for medical emergencies; lapses at year-end.
VPN	Virtual Private Network. Mandatory secure tunnel required for remote access to company servers.

WFH	Work From Home. Approved remote work days, up to 2 days per week for eligible hybrid employees.
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References to Other Company Documents

The NexaCore Knowledge Base consists of eight core governance documents. This Employee Handbook is the entry point to all of them. Each is published on the HRMS (Workday) document library and mirrored on Confluence.

Table FM-4: NexaCore Core Governance Documents and Their Owners

Document	Document Owner	What It Contains
HR Handbook (this document)	Ritika Sharma, CHRO	Comprehensive guide on company culture, employment terms, performance and workplace conduct.
Leave Policy	Employee Success (HRBP)	Accrual, application and approval workflows for all time-off categories.
Expense & Reimbursement Policy	Siddharth Kapoor, Director of Finance	Acceptable limits, receipt requirements and claim processes for operational costs.
Information Security Policy	Ananya Rao, CISO	Data protection, asset management, network security and compliance protocols.
Employee Benefits Guide	Payroll & Benefits Team	Health insurance, wellness programmes and retirement benefits.
Remote Work Policy	Employee Success (HRBP)	Eligibility, equipment allowances and security expectations for WFH and hybrid schedules.
Code of Conduct	Legal & Compliance Team	Ethical expectations, conflict of interest, anti-harassment (POSH) and disciplinary procedures.
Travel Policy	Siddharth Kapoor, Director of Finance	Domestic and international travel approvals, hotel categories and per diem rates.

IMPORTANT: This handbook summarises the seven companion policies for orientation purposes only. It does not restate them in full. Where an employee needs a definitive answer on leave accrual, an expense limit, a travel entitlement, an insurance claim or a disciplinary process, the companion policy document is the controlling source and must be consulted directly.

1. Company Overview

1.1 History of NexaCore Technologies

NexaCore Technologies was founded in Bengaluru, Karnataka, by a small group of enterprise software engineers who believed that large organisations were being held back not by a shortage of data, but by an inability to read, structure and act on the documents they already owned. The company began as a services partner building custom integration layers for banking and insurance clients. Within its first three years it had established a reputation for delivering complex, regulated, high-availability systems on schedule — a reputation that remains the foundation of the NexaCore client relationship model today.

The decisive turn in the company's history came with the creation of the Document Intelligence Team, now part of the Product & AI Development group. What began as an internal accelerator for extracting structured data from client contracts and claim forms matured into a productised platform, and NexaCore transitioned from a pure services organisation into a hybrid product-and-services enterprise. That transition drove rapid expansion: the Western Delivery Center opened at IT Space, Pune, Maharashtra to support large-scale delivery engagements; the Southern R&D Center opened at Innovation Tower, Hyderabad, Telangana to concentrate deep research capability; and the Northern Regional Hub opened at Cyber Heights, Patiala, Punjab to widen the company's engineering talent base across northern India.

NexaCore Technologies today employs **4,500 people** across those four locations, with its Global Headquarters at TechPark One, Bengaluru, Karnataka. The company operates on a financial year running from **1 April to 31 March**, and its governance, promotion and increment cycles are aligned to that calendar. Growth has been deliberate rather than opportunistic: NexaCore has consistently chosen depth in enterprise document intelligence over breadth across unrelated markets, and that focus is reflected in the structure of its business units, its hiring profile and its long-term goals.

1.2 Mission

MISSION: To engineer scalable, secure, and intelligent digital solutions that empower global enterprises to operate at peak efficiency.

Each phrase in the NexaCore mission statement carries operational weight. **Scalable** means systems are designed from the first sprint to serve enterprise volumes, not pilot volumes. **Secure** means security is a design input owned by every engineer, not a review gate applied at the end — which is why the Information Security Policy, owned by CISO Ananya Rao, is one of the eight core governance documents every employee must read. **Intelligent** means our platforms apply machine learning to reduce manual effort measurably, not decoratively. **Peak efficiency** means we measure our success by the operational improvement our clients realise, not by the volume of software we ship.

1.3 Vision

VISION: To be the world's most trusted partner in enterprise digital transformation and document intelligence by 2030.

The NexaCore vision is anchored on the word *trusted*. Trust in the enterprise segment is earned through predictable delivery, verifiable security posture, transparent commercial conduct and long-term client relationships. Every internal policy in this handbook — from the prohibition on personal USB drives to the requirement for itemised receipts on client meals — exists to protect that trust.

1.4 Core Values

Table 1-1: NexaCore Core Values and Their Practical Application

Value	Statement	What It Looks Like in Daily Work
Integrity First	We operate with absolute transparency and ethical rigor.	Declaring a conflict of interest to the Legal & Compliance Team before it becomes an issue; submitting accurate expense claims with valid GST receipts; never posting client names or code snippets on social media.
Customer Centricity	Our solutions are built around client success.	Designing to the client's operating reality rather than to internal convenience; formal business attire and full preparation for every client-facing meeting; escalating delivery risk early rather than absorbing it silently.
Agile Innovation	We adapt, iterate, and invent continuously.	Shipping in short increments; using the annual certification budget to keep skills current; participating in internal hackathons; challenging an approach constructively even when it is already in flight.
Inclusive Excellence	We foster a workplace where diverse perspectives drive superior outcomes.	Ensuring every voice in a design review is heard; scheduling meetings inside core hours (10:00 AM – 04:00 PM) so hybrid and flexi-hour colleagues can attend; zero tolerance for harassment, enforced through the Internal Complaints Committee.

1.5 Business Domains

NexaCore Technologies concentrates on enterprise segments where document volume, regulatory obligation and process complexity intersect. The company's domain focus is stable and deliberate.

Table 1-2: Primary Business Domains Served by NexaCore Technologies

Domain	Typical Engagement Profile
Banking & Financial Services	Loan origination document processing, KYC automation, regulatory reporting pipelines and core-system integration for scheduled and private-sector banks.
Insurance	Claims intake and adjudication support, policy document extraction, fraud-signal detection and underwriting workflow modernisation.
Healthcare & Life Sciences	Clinical documentation structuring, records digitisation and compliance-grade audit trails for hospital networks and research organisations.

Manufacturing & Logistics	Supply-chain document reconciliation, invoice and bill-of-lading extraction, and operational analytics platforms.
Public Sector & Regulated Utilities	Large-scale records digitisation, citizen-service workflow platforms and long-horizon system modernisation programmes.
Technology & SaaS	Embedded document intelligence capability, platform engineering support and site reliability engagements for high-growth software companies.

1.6 Global Presence and Office Locations

NexaCore operates four offices in India. Each site has a defined strategic role, and employees are assigned to a base location recorded in the HRMS (Workday). Detailed facility information for each site is provided in Section 4 of this handbook.

Table 1-3: NexaCore Technologies Office Locations and Strategic Roles

Office Designation	Facility & City	Strategic Role
Global Headquarters	TechPark One, Bengaluru, Karnataka	Executive leadership, corporate functions, Human Resources, Finance, Legal & Compliance, Sales & Marketing and the largest engineering population. All Day 1 induction sessions are held here.
Northern Regional Hub	Cyber Heights, Patiala, Punjab	Engineering delivery capacity for northern India, QA & Automation, IT Support & Asset Management and Customer Success operations for the northern client portfolio.
Western Delivery Center	IT Space, Pune, Maharashtra	Large-scale programme delivery, DevOps & Site Reliability, backend engineering pods and the primary delivery interface for western-region banking and manufacturing clients.
Southern R&D Center	Innovation Tower, Hyderabad, Telangana	Deep research and platform development, including the AI Platform & Machine Learning team and advanced work supporting the Document Intelligence product line.

1.7 Products and Platforms

NexaCore's product portfolio is built and maintained by the Product & AI Development group. The Document Intelligence Team, led by Meera Krishnan, Director of AI, is the anchor team for the company's flagship capability.

- **Document Intelligence Platform** — the company's flagship product, providing automated ingestion, classification, extraction and validation of high-volume enterprise documents. Owned by the Document Intelligence Team.
- **AI Platform & Machine Learning Services** — the shared model training, evaluation, deployment and monitoring layer underpinning all intelligent features across the portfolio. Owned by the AI Platform & Machine Learning team at the Southern R&D Center, Hyderabad.
- **Enterprise Workflow & Integration Suite** — connectors, orchestration and integration tooling that link the Document Intelligence Platform to client core systems. Built by Backend Engineering with DevOps & Site Reliability.
- **Internal HRMS Product** — the configuration, extension and support layer over Workday used by all 4,500 employees for leave, payroll, performance and document access. Owned by the HRMS Product Team.
- **Internal Finance Systems** — expense, reimbursement, invoicing and financial reporting systems. Owned by the Finance Systems Team in partnership with Finance & Administration.

1.8 Business Units

NexaCore is organised into functional groups that map directly to document ownership and technical responsibility. The five groups are Engineering & IT; Product & AI Development; Security & Compliance; Human Resources; and Finance & Administration. Commercial functions — Sales & Marketing, Customer Success and Operations — interface with all five. The full team-level breakdown appears in Section 2.3.

1.9 Long-Term Goals

1. **Category leadership in document intelligence.** Establish the Document Intelligence Platform as the reference solution for regulated industries, measured by client retention and reference-ability rather than by licence count alone.
2. **Verifiable security and compliance posture.** Maintain an audit-ready security position across every engagement, governed by the Information Security Policy and the Risk & Governance team under the CISO.
3. **Deep engineering bench strength.** Grow internal capability through the certification budget, structured mentorship and the Internal Job Posting programme so that the majority of L4 and L5 roles are filled internally.
4. **Predictable, high-quality delivery at scale.** Sustain delivery performance as headcount grows, supported by QA & Automation, DevOps & Site Reliability and disciplined programme governance.
5. **An employer of choice across four cities.** Provide a consistent employee experience — same grades, same benefits, same policies — whether an employee is based in Bengaluru, Patiala, Pune or Hyderabad.

1.10 Future Vision

Looking towards 2030, NexaCore intends to deepen rather than diversify. The company's forward plan concentrates on making document intelligence more autonomous, more explainable and more tightly embedded in client operations — extending from extraction into decision support, while retaining the human review and audit trails that regulated clients require. Internally, the same period will see continued investment in the Southern R&D Center as the company's research engine and in the Northern Regional Hub as its fastest-growing delivery base.

Achieving this vision depends less on technology strategy than on consistency of execution: hiring well, developing people through the L1 to L6 career ladder, protecting client data without exception, and behaving with the integrity that the company's first value demands. That is the practical purpose of the policies contained in the remainder of this handbook.

2. Organization Structure

2.1 Executive Leadership

NexaCore Technologies is led by an executive team at grade L6, supported by senior leadership at grade L5 and mid-level management at grade L4. The individuals listed below are the ultimate escalation points and document owners for their respective functions. Employees should follow the escalation path described in Section 10.9 rather than approaching executive leadership directly in the first instance.

Table 2-1: NexaCore Leadership and Key Personnel

Name	Role	Job Grade	Department
Arjun Mehta	Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	L6	Executive
Priya Nair	Chief Technology Officer (CTO)	L6	Engineering & IT
Ritika Sharma	Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)	L6	Human Resources
Vikram Desai	Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	L6	Finance
Ananya Rao	Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)	L6	Security & Compliance
Rohan Gupta	VP of Engineering	L5	Engineering & IT
Meera Krishnan	Director of AI (Document Intelligence)	L5	Product & AI
Siddharth Kapoor	Director of Finance	L5	Finance
Amit Verma	Facilities Manager	L4	Administration (Bengaluru)

2.2 Departments

NexaCore Technologies is composed of eight departments. Every employee is mapped to exactly one department in the HRMS (Workday), and that mapping determines approval routing for leave, expenses, travel and access requests.

Table 2-2: NexaCore Departments and Core Responsibilities

Department	Core Responsibilities
Engineering & IT	Builds and operates all client-facing and internal software. Covers Frontend Engineering, Backend Engineering, QA & Automation, DevOps & Site Reliability, and IT Support & Asset Management. Led by CTO Priya Nair with VP of Engineering Rohan Gupta.
Product Development	Owns product strategy, roadmap and delivery for the Document Intelligence Platform, AI Platform, HRMS Product and Finance Systems. Includes the AI research function under Director of AI Meera Krishnan.
Human Resources (HR)	Owns the employee lifecycle end to end: Talent Acquisition, Employee Success (HRBPs), and Payroll & Benefits. Owns this handbook, the Leave Policy and the Remote Work Policy. Led by CHRO Ritika Sharma.
Legal & Compliance	Owns the Code of Conduct, contract review, regulatory compliance, conflict-of-interest adjudication and support to the Internal Complaints Committee on POSH matters.
Finance	Owns financial planning, accounts payable and receivable, payroll disbursement, the Expense & Reimbursement Policy and the Travel Policy. Led by CFO Vikram Desai with Director of Finance Siddharth Kapoor.
Sales & Marketing	Owns revenue generation, client acquisition, brand and market positioning, analyst relations and pre-sales solutioning.
Customer Success	Owns post-sale client relationships, adoption, renewals, escalation management and the voice of the customer inside product planning.
Operations	Owns delivery governance, resource management, workforce planning, vendor management and cross-functional programme coordination.

2.3 Functional Group and Team Hierarchy

Within the departments, NexaCore is divided into specific functional groups. This structure is used to assign document ownership, technical responsibility and on-call accountability.

Table 2-3: NexaCore Functional Groups and Constituent Teams

Functional Group	Teams
Engineering & IT	Frontend Engineering; Backend Engineering; QA & Automation; DevOps & Site Reliability; IT Support & Asset Management
Product & AI Development	Document Intelligence Team; AI Platform & Machine Learning; HRMS Product Team; Finance Systems Team
Security & Compliance	Security Engineering; Risk & Governance
Human Resources (HR)	Talent Acquisition (Recruiting); Employee Success (HRBPs); Payroll & Benefits
Finance & Administration	Accounts Payable / Receivable; Facilities & Workspace Management

2.4 Reporting Structure

NexaCore operates a clear line-management structure. Every employee has exactly one line manager recorded in the HRMS, and that manager is the default approver for leave, attendance corrections, expenses and domestic travel. The reporting chain is used consistently for approvals, performance reviews and grievance escalation.

Table 2-4: Standard Reporting and Approval Chain

Employee Grade	Typically Reports To	Approvals Held by That Manager
L1 (Intern / Trainee)	L3 Senior Executive or L4 Manager (assigned mentor plus reporting manager)	Attendance, leave, project work allocation. Exceptional office-attendance exceptions require L5 Director approval.

L2 (Associate)	L3 Team Lead or L4 Manager	Leave, attendance corrections, hybrid schedule, mobile phone reimbursement, expense claims within limit.
L3 (Senior Executive / Specialist)	L4 Manager	Leave, expense claims, certification pre-approval routing, conference nomination.
L4 (Manager / Principal)	L5 Director / VP	Domestic travel approval, certification pre-approval, promotion recommendation, team leave planning.
L5 (Director / VP)	L6 C-Suite Executive	International travel approval, out-of-policy exceptions, intern WFH exceptions, budget sign-off.
L6 (C-Suite)	Chief Executive Officer / Board	Organisational policy, promotion to L6, strategic and financial authority.
C1 (Consultant / Contractor)	Engagement owner at L4 or above	Work allocation, attendance, site access. Commercial matters route via Operations and Finance.

2.5 Team Collaboration

NexaCore teams are distributed across four cities, and collaboration norms exist to keep that distribution invisible to clients. The following practices are expected of every team.

- **Schedule inside core hours.** All cross-team meetings must fall within the core working hours of 10:00 AM to 04:00 PM so that colleagues on flexi-hours or hybrid schedules can attend.
- **Write it down.** Decisions taken in a meeting are recorded on Confluence. Work items live in Jira. Code and technical design live in GitHub Enterprise. Chat on Slack is not a system of record.
- **One owner per item.** Every Jira ticket, Confluence page and production service has a single named owner. Shared ownership without a named individual is treated as no ownership.
- **Escalate early.** Delivery risk is escalated to the L4 Manager as soon as it is credible, not when it materialises. Early escalation is treated as good practice, never as failure.
- **Include the whole room.** In design reviews and retrospectives, the facilitator is responsible for ensuring that quieter participants and remote participants are actively invited to contribute.

2.6 Job Grades and Career Levels

NexaCore uses a seven-point grade structure. Grade determines management level, leave entitlement, expense limits, travel entitlement, hybrid work eligibility, hardware allocation and promotion path. Grades are recorded in the HRMS and are visible on every employee profile.

Table 2-5: NexaCore Job Grades, Titles and Management Levels

Job Grade	Title Classification	Employee Type	Management Level
L1	Intern / Trainee	Temporary / Trainee	Individual Contributor
L2	Associate / Junior Executive	Full-Time Employee (FTE)	Individual Contributor
L3	Senior Executive / Specialist	Full-Time Employee (FTE)	Individual Contributor / Team Lead
L4	Manager / Principal	Full-Time Employee (FTE)	Mid-Level Management
L5	Director / VP	Full-Time Employee (FTE)	Senior Management
L6	C-Suite (CEO, CTO, CFO)	Full-Time Employee (FTE)	Executive Leadership
C1	Consultant / Contractor	Contractual	Non-Management

2.7 Employee Categories

Three employee categories exist at NexaCore, and category — not job title — determines entitlement. Employees should always check their category before assuming a benefit applies.

Table 2-6: Employee Categories and Key Entitlement Differences

Attribute	FTE (L2-L6)	Intern / Trainee (L1)	Consultant / Contractor (C1)
Probation Period	6 months	Not applicable (fixed-term internship)	Not applicable (contract term)
Notice Period	60 days	15 days	30 days
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	6 days	0 days
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	0 days	0 days
Sick Leave (SL)	6 days	3 days	0 days
Corporate Health Insurance	Covered (GMC, GTL, GPA)	Not covered	Not covered
Hybrid / Work From Home	Eligible after probation, up to 2 days per week	100% from office unless approved by an L5 Director	As specified in the contract of engagement
WFH Setup Allowance	₹15,000 one-time	Not applicable	Not applicable
Certification Budget	₹25,000 (L2-L3) / ₹50,000 (L4+) per year	Not applicable	Not applicable
Learning Platform Access	Udemy for Business and LinkedIn Learning	Udemy for Business and LinkedIn Learning	Udemy for Business and LinkedIn Learning

NOTE: Leave entitlements for L1 Interns are pro-rated based on a standard six-month internship duration. All leave balances are calculated per calendar year, from 1 January to 31 December, which is distinct from the NexaCore financial year of 1 April to 31 March. Refer to the **Leave Policy** for complete accrual and application rules.

3. Employment Lifecycle

This section describes the complete NexaCore employment lifecycle from recruitment through to Full and Final Settlement. Every stage described here is transacted through the **HRMS (Workday)**, which is the single system of record for offers, joining documentation, probation, performance, leave, promotion, resignation and exit. Email and Slack are not valid channels for any lifecycle transaction.

Table 3-1: NexaCore Employee Lifecycle Stages at a Glance

#	Stage	Owner	Key Standard or Timeline
1	Recruitment	Talent Acquisition	Structured multi-stage interview process
2	Offer Letter	Talent Acquisition	Issued digitally; accepted through the HRMS
3	Joining & Induction	Employee Success (HRBP)	Induction begins 09:00 AM on Day 1 at HQ
4	IT Asset Handover	IT Support & Asset Management	11:30 AM on Day 1
5	Background Verification (BGV)	HireRight (third-party vendor)	Must be completed within 30 days of joining
6	Probation	Reporting Manager + HRBP	6 months for Full-Time Employees
7	Confirmation	Reporting Manager + HRBP	On successful completion of probation
8	Performance Review	Reporting Manager	Mid-Year in October; Annual in March
9	Promotion	Manager (L4+) + HR Business Partner	Annual cycle, effective 1 April
10	Resignation	Employee via HRMS	60 / 15 / 30 days' notice by category
11	Asset Return	IT Service Desk	By 4:00 PM on the Last Working Day (LWD)
12	Full & Final Settlement	Payroll & Benefits	Processed after clearance of all dues
13	Experience Letter	Employee Success (HRBP)	Generated automatically 45 days after F&F

3.1 Recruitment

Recruitment at NexaCore is owned by the Talent Acquisition team within Human Resources. Every open position originates from an approved headcount requisition raised in the HRMS by the hiring manager and signed off by the relevant L5 Director. Candidates progress through a structured process consisting of a recruiter screen, one or more technical or functional assessments, a hiring-manager interview, a cross-functional or values interview, and a final leadership review for senior roles. Interview panels are briefed to evaluate against a documented scorecard so that assessments remain consistent and free from bias, in line with the Inclusive Excellence value.

All interview panel members are required to wear **formal business attire** when serving on a panel, as described in Section 6.4. Panel members must declare any personal relationship with a candidate to the Talent Acquisition team and recuse themselves; failure to do so is treated as a conflict of interest under the Code of Conduct.

3.2 Offer Letter

Successful candidates receive a digital offer letter issued by Talent Acquisition through the HRMS. The offer letter specifies the job grade (L1 to L6, or C1 for contractors), title classification, employee type, base location, reporting manager, compensation structure, joining date and the applicable probation and notice period. Acceptance is recorded electronically in the HRMS; verbal or email acceptance is not sufficient to confirm a joining date.

WARNING: Offers are made conditional upon successful Background Verification and document verification. Any discrepancy discovered between the information declared by the candidate and the verified record may result in withdrawal of the offer or, if employment has already commenced, immediate termination.

3.3 Joining Process

All new joiners — regardless of base location — attend induction at the Global Headquarters, TechPark One, Bengaluru, Karnataka. The Day 1 schedule is fixed and standardised.

Table 3-2: Standard Day 1 Joining Schedule

Time	Activity	Owner and Notes
09:00 AM	Induction begins	Employee Success (HRBP) team, Global Headquarters, Bengaluru. Attendance is mandatory and punctual arrival is expected.
09:00 – 10:30 AM	Company overview, values, policies	Introduction to the mission, vision, core values and the eight core governance documents.
10:30 – 11:30 AM	Documentation and HRMS enrolment	Payroll & Benefits. Bank details, PF nomination, tax declaration setup and insurance nomination.
11:30 AM	IT asset handover	IT Support & Asset Management. Laptop issued per the Role-Based Laptop Specifications, MDM enrolment, VPN setup, email and Slack provisioning.
Day 1 (during induction)	ID card issuance	Security Desk / Facilities. Biometric enrolment for turnstile access.

Afternoon	Team introduction	Reporting manager and assigned buddy. Workspace allocation and first-week plan.
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3.4 Background Verification (BGV)

Background Verification is mandatory for all employees and is managed through the third-party vendor **HireRight**. BGV covers employment history, educational credentials, address verification and criminal record checks. The process **must be completed within 30 days of joining**. New joiners are responsible for responding promptly to HireRight requests for documentation; delays caused by a non-responsive candidate are treated as a failure to complete BGV.

WARNING: Discrepancies identified during Background Verification may result in **immediate termination** of employment. This includes misrepresented dates of employment, unverifiable qualifications, undisclosed prior terminations and false address declarations.

3.5 Document Verification

In parallel with BGV, new joiners upload the following documents to the HRMS document locker. Original documents are inspected at induction and returned immediately; NexaCore does not retain original certificates.

- Government photo identification and address proof
- Permanent Account Number (PAN) card and Provident Fund / Universal Account Number details
- Educational certificates and mark sheets for the highest qualification claimed
- Relieving letter and experience letters from all previous employers
- Salary slips or compensation proof for the most recent employment, where applicable
- Cancelled cheque or bank account proof for salary credit
- Passport-size photographs for the ID card and HRMS profile

3.6 Probation

All Full-Time Employees serve a **probation period of 6 months** from the date of joining. During probation, the reporting manager conducts structured check-ins at the 30-day, 90-day and 150-day marks, each recorded in the HRMS. Probation is a period of mutual assessment: the employee demonstrates capability and cultural fit, and NexaCore demonstrates that the role and support structure match what was described at offer stage.

Employees on probation are **not eligible for hybrid work**. Eligibility for the hybrid schedule of up to two days per week from home begins only on successful completion of the six-month probation period, as described in Section 13.5 and the Remote Work Policy.

3.7 Confirmation

On successful completion of probation, the reporting manager submits a confirmation recommendation in the HRMS, which is reviewed and approved by the HR Business Partner. Confirmation unlocks hybrid work eligibility and starts the tenure clock used for promotion eligibility. Where performance during probation has been inadequate, the manager may recommend an extension of probation or separation; both routes require HR Business Partner approval and are handled with documented feedback.

3.8 Transfers

Employees may be transferred between office locations, departments or teams, either at the request of the business or on the employee's own application. All transfer requests are raised in the HRMS and require approval from the releasing manager, the receiving manager and the HR Business Partner. Location transfers are effective from an agreed date that allows for a structured handover of active work.

Where a company-requested relocation involves a move of more than 100 kilometres, the employee is eligible for a relocation reimbursement of up to ₹30,000 for grades L2 and L3, and up to ₹75,000 for grades L4 and above. Interns (L1) and Contractors (C1) are not eligible for relocation support. Refer to the **Expense & Reimbursement Policy** for claim requirements.

3.9 Internal Job Posting (IJP)

NexaCore fills roles internally wherever possible. All open positions are published on the Internal Job Posting board within the HRMS before or alongside external advertising. To apply through the IJP programme an employee must have completed probation, must have spent a minimum of 12 months in their current role, and must hold a performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or above. Applications are confidential until the interview stage, at which point the current reporting manager is informed.

3.10 Promotion Overview

Promotions at NexaCore run on a single **annual cycle, effective 1 April** of every financial year. Three conditions must be satisfied simultaneously.

1. **Tenure.** A minimum of **18 months in the current grade** is required to be eligible for promotion to the next grade, subject to the grade-specific minimum tenure shown in Table 3-3.
2. **Performance.** The employee must achieve a minimum annual rating of "**4 - Exceeds Expectations**".
3. **Approval.** A direct manager recommendation (L4 or above) plus HR Business Partner approval is mandatory. Promotions to L6 additionally require Board approval.

Table 3-3: Promotion Matrix — Tenure, Certifications and Salary Bands

Current Grade	Target Grade	Min. Tenure	Required Certifications (Examples)	Base Salary Band (INR)
L1 (Intern)	L2	6 months	AWS Cloud Practitioner	₹6,00,000 – ₹9,00,000
L2 (Associate)	L3	18 months	AWS Developer / CKA	₹9,00,000 – ₹15,00,000
L3 (Senior)	L4	24 months	PMP / Scrum Master / CISSP	₹15,00,000 – ₹28,00,000
L4 (Manager)	L5	36 months	Executive Leadership Program	₹28,00,000 – ₹45,00,000
L5 (Director)	L6	Not applicable	Board Approval Required	₹45,00,000+

NOTE: Required certifications must be documented in the HRMS to count towards promotion eligibility. Certification costs are reimbursable within the annual certification budget (₹25,000 for L2 and L3; ₹50,000 for L4 and above), provided the certification is pre-approved by an L4 or above and is relevant to the employee's role.

3.11 Resignation

Resignation must be submitted through the **HRMS**. A resignation communicated only by email, Slack or verbally is not recognised and does not start the notice period. The notice period runs from the date the resignation is submitted and accepted in the system.

Table 3-4: Notice Period by Employee Category

Category	Grades	Notice Period	Approver
Full-Time Employee (FTE)	L2 and above	60 days	Reporting Manager + HR Business Partner
Intern / Trainee	L1	15 days	Reporting Manager
Consultant / Contractor	C1	30 days	Engagement Owner (L4+) + Operations

3.12 Exit Process

Once a resignation is accepted, the HRMS generates an exit checklist assigned to the employee, the reporting manager, IT Support & Asset Management, Finance and the HR Business Partner. The employee is responsible for completing a documented knowledge-transfer handover to a named successor, closing or reassigning all open Jira items, transferring ownership of Confluence pages and GitHub Enterprise repositories, and settling all outstanding expense claims before the Last Working Day. An exit interview is conducted by the Employee Success (HRBP) team; participation is voluntary but strongly encouraged.

3.13 Asset Return

All company assets must be surrendered to the **IT Service Desk by 4:00 PM on the Last Working Day (LWD)**. This includes the company-issued laptop and charger, any additional peripherals, monitors issued for home use, access cards and any hardware security keys.

WARNING: Assets not returned by 4:00 PM on the Last Working Day will be recovered from the Full and Final Settlement at depreciated replacement value. Asset clearance is a mandatory prerequisite for the release of the F&F settlement and the Experience Letter.

3.14 Full and Final Settlement (F&F)

The Full and Final Settlement is the final payroll calculation on exit, processed by the Payroll & Benefits team. It includes salary payable up to the Last Working Day, encashment of eligible Earned Leave balance, any pending approved reimbursements, gratuity where the employee has completed five continuous years of service, and variable pay where applicable — less recoveries for unreturned assets, notice shortfall, ID card replacement charges or any advance outstanding. F&F is processed only after IT, Finance and Facilities clearance has been recorded in the HRMS.

3.15 Experience Letter

The Experience Letter is **generated automatically 45 days after the Full and Final Settlement is completed**. It is issued to the employee's registered personal email address and is also available for download from the HRMS. Employees do not need to raise a separate request. Requests for employment verification while still employed — for visa applications, loan processing or rental agreements — are raised as a "Letter Request" ticket in the HRMS and are issued by the Employee Success (HRBP) team.

4. Office Information

4.1 Office Locations

NexaCore Technologies operates four offices across India. Every employee is assigned a base location recorded in the HRMS. Employees visiting a site other than their base location must be pre-registered by their host through the Facilities team at the destination site.

Table 4-1: NexaCore Office Locations

Designation	Facility	City / State	Primary Functions Hosted
Global Headquarters	TechPark One	Bengaluru, Karnataka	Executive Leadership, HR, Finance, Legal & Compliance, Sales & Marketing, Engineering
Northern Regional Hub	Cyber Heights	Patiala, Punjab	Engineering, QA & Automation, IT Support & Asset Management, Customer Success
Western Delivery Center	IT Space	Pune, Maharashtra	Programme Delivery, Backend Engineering, DevOps & Site Reliability
Southern R&D Center	Innovation Tower	Hyderabad, Telangana	AI Platform & Machine Learning, Document Intelligence research

4.2 Facilities at the Global Headquarters (TechPark One, Bengaluru)

The Global Headquarters is the company's largest facility and sets the facility standard for all other sites. Facilities at TechPark One are managed by **Amit Verma, Facilities Manager (L4), Administration, Bengaluru**, supported by the Facilities & Workspace Management team.

Table 4-2: Global Headquarters Facility Directory (TechPark One, Bengaluru)

Facility	Location	Access and Operating Details
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Main Lobby & Reception	Ground Floor	Biometric turnstiles at the main lobby. Reception handles visitor check-in, courier receipt and lost property.
Security Desk	Ground Floor, adjacent to Reception	Staffed 24/7. Handles access-card issues, incident logging and after-hours entry authorisation.
Medical Room	Ground Floor, East Wing	Staffed by a registered nurse 24/7. First aid, basic medication, rest facility and ambulance coordination.
Cafeteria	4th Floor	Open 07:00 AM to 10:00 PM daily.
Gymnasium	2nd Floor	Free access for Full-Time Employees. Requires a signed safety waiver before first use.
Car Parking — Basement 1	Basement 1	Reserved for grades L4 and above.
Car Parking — Basement 2	Basement 2	General parking for grades L1 to L3.
Two-Wheeler Parking	Basement 3	Available to all employees, interns and contractors.
Emergency Exits	East and West wings, every floor	Must remain unobstructed at all times.
Fire Assembly Point	North Lawn	The single designated assembly point for the entire building.

4.3 Medical Room

The Medical Room at the Global Headquarters is located on the **Ground Floor, East Wing** and is staffed by a registered nurse **24 hours a day, seven days a week**. It provides first aid, over-the-counter medication, a rest facility for employees who feel unwell during the working day, and coordination of ambulance transfer to the nearest hospital where required. Employees who feel unwell should inform their reporting manager and proceed to the Medical Room rather than attempting to continue working. Any workplace injury, however minor, must be logged with the nurse so that an incident record exists.

4.4 Parking

Parking at TechPark One is allocated by job grade. Basement 1 is reserved for employees at grade L4 and above. Basement 2 provides general car parking for grades L1 to L3 on a first-come basis. Basement 3 is dedicated two-wheeler parking available to all employees, interns and contractors. Vehicles must display a valid NexaCore parking sticker issued by the Facilities team. Parking in fire lanes, in front of emergency exits or in spaces reserved for persons with disabilities is prohibited without exception.

4.5 Gymnasium

The gymnasium on the 2nd Floor is available free of charge to Full-Time Employees. Before first use, employees must complete and sign a safety waiver held by the Facilities team. Appropriate athletic footwear is mandatory; open-toe shoes and flip-flops are not permitted in the gym. Employees with existing medical conditions should consult a physician before using the equipment and are encouraged to inform the Medical Room nurse.

4.6 Meeting Rooms

Meeting rooms across all four locations are booked through the calendar system linked to corporate email. The following conventions apply company-wide.

- Book only the capacity you need. Booking a twelve-person boardroom for a two-person discussion blocks a scarce resource.
- Release the booking as soon as you know the meeting is cancelled. A room held for more than 10 minutes past the start time without occupancy may be reallocated by the Facilities team.
- Schedule cross-team meetings within core hours (10:00 AM to 04:00 PM) so that hybrid and flexi-hour colleagues can attend.
- Leave the room as you found it: whiteboards cleared, chairs replaced, no cups or papers left behind.
- Client-facing meeting rooms adjacent to Reception must be booked at least 24 hours in advance and require the host to be in formal business attire.

4.7 Emergency Assembly Area

The designated fire assembly point for the Global Headquarters is the **North Lawn**. On hearing the evacuation alarm, employees must leave by the nearest emergency exit — located in the East and West wings of every floor — and proceed directly to the North Lawn for roll call. Full evacuation procedure is described in Section 11.2.

4.8 Reception and Security Desk

Reception is the first point of contact for all visitors, couriers and contractors arriving at a NexaCore facility. The Security Desk, staffed 24 hours a day, handles access-card malfunctions, after-hours entry authorisation, incident reporting and the escorting of visitors where a host is delayed. Employees who lose their access card while on site should report to the Security Desk immediately for a temporary day pass; a permanent replacement is arranged through the Facilities team.

4.9 Visitor Policy

All visitors must be **pre-registered via the Envoy app at least 24 hours in advance** by the host employee. On arrival, visitors check in at Reception, present photo identification and receive a visitor badge that must be worn visibly at all times.

WARNING: Escort by the host employee is mandatory beyond the lobby. A visitor must never be left unattended inside the office, in a meeting room, or near an unlocked workstation. Hosts are personally accountable for their visitors from check-in to check-out.

4.10 Access Cards and Building Access

Every employee, intern and contractor is issued a NexaCore ID card on **Day 1**. The ID card serves three functions: photographic identification, biometric-linked turnstile access, and automatic attendance logging as described in Section 5.3.

- **The ID card must be worn visibly at all times** inside NexaCore premises.
- Access is granted through **biometric turnstiles at the main lobby**. Tailgating — allowing another person to pass through a turnstile on your card tap — is a security violation and must be reported to the Security Desk.
- ID cards must never be shared, lent or used by another person.
- A lost ID card must be reported to the Security Desk and the Facilities team immediately so that it can be deactivated.
- **Replacement for a lost card costs ₹500, deducted from payroll.**
- Access rights are grade- and site-specific. Access to server rooms and hardware labs is granted only on approved request through the IT Service Desk.

4.11 Office Timings

Standard working hours across all four NexaCore offices are **09:00 AM to 06:00 PM local time, Monday to Friday**, with mandatory core hours of **10:00 AM to 04:00 PM**. Buildings remain accessible outside these hours for employees with valid access cards, subject to after-hours notification to the Security Desk. The cafeteria at the Global Headquarters operates from 07:00 AM to 10:00 PM, and the Medical Room is staffed around the clock. Complete attendance rules are set out in Section 5.

4.12 Office Layout Description (Global Headquarters)

The following text description of the TechPark One layout is provided for orientation and for emergency familiarisation. New joiners are given a guided walkthrough during induction.

Table 4-3: TechPark One Floor-by-Floor Layout Description

Level	Description
Basement 3	Two-wheeler parking for all employees. Stairwell access to the Ground Floor lobby at the north end.
Basement 2	General car parking for grades L1 to L3. Lift lobby at the centre of the level connects to all floors.
Basement 1	Reserved car parking for grades L4 and above. Electrical and building services rooms are located along the west side and are restricted to Facilities personnel.
Ground Floor	Main lobby with biometric turnstiles at the entrance. Reception is directly ahead of the entrance; the Security Desk sits adjacent to Reception. The Medical Room is in the East Wing. Client-facing meeting rooms are arranged along the east corridor beyond Reception. Emergency exits are at the far East and West ends.
1st Floor	Open-plan workspace, primarily Sales & Marketing and Customer Success. Collaboration booths along the window line; two mid-size meeting rooms in the core.
2nd Floor	Gymnasium (west side, requires signed safety waiver), wellness and quiet rooms, and open-plan workspace for Operations and Finance & Administration.
3rd Floor	Human Resources, Legal & Compliance, and interview rooms. The HR Business Partner pods sit on the east side, closest to the lift lobby.
4th Floor	Cafeteria (07:00 AM to 10:00 PM) spanning the north face, with informal seating and breakout areas on the south face.
5th Floor and above	Engineering & IT and Product & AI Development workspaces, arranged in team pods with adjacent stand-up areas and design-review rooms. Server rooms and hardware labs are located on the secured west side, with access restricted by approved request only.
All floors	Emergency exits are located at the East and West wings of every floor. Fire extinguishers and fire alarm call points are positioned at each stairwell entrance. The fire assembly point for the entire building is the North Lawn.

NOTE: Open-toe shoes, flip-flops and shorts are **strictly prohibited in all server rooms and hardware labs at all times**, regardless of the day of the week or the prevailing dress code. See Section 6.7.

5. Working Hours and Attendance

5.1 Standard Working Hours

Standard working hours at NexaCore Technologies are **09:00 AM to 06:00 PM local time, Monday to Friday**, across all four office locations. This constitutes a nine-hour day inclusive of breaks. Saturday and Sunday are non-working days for all employees unless the employee is part of a rostered support or on-call arrangement agreed in advance with their L4 manager.

Table 5-1: NexaCore Standard Working Hours and Time Definitions

Parameter	Standard	Notes
Standard Working Hours	09:00 AM – 06:00 PM	Local time at the employee's base location, Monday to Friday.
Core Working Hours	10:00 AM – 04:00 PM	Mandatory availability. Applies to all employees including those on flexi-hours and hybrid schedules.
Working Days	Monday to Friday	Saturday and Sunday are non-working days.
Late-Coming Threshold	10:30 AM	Swiping in after this time without prior flexi-hour approval triggers a leave deduction.
Half-Day Definition	Fewer than 4.5 hours	Working fewer than 4.5 hours in a calendar day is recorded as a half-day.
Flexi-Hours Day Length	9 hours	Employees may set their own 9-hour schedule provided core hours are fully covered.
Financial Year	1 April – 31 March	Governs promotions, increments and variable pay cycles.

Leave Year	1 January – 31 December	All leave balances are calculated per calendar year.
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5.2 Core Working Hours

Core working hours of **10:00 AM to 04:00 PM** represent mandatory availability. During this window every employee must be reachable, present in the office or online from an approved work-from-home location, and available for meetings. Core hours exist so that a distributed workforce — spread across Bengaluru, Patiala, Pune and Hyderabad, and split between office and home — has a guaranteed common window for collaboration. All cross-team meetings, design reviews, stand-ups and client calls should be scheduled inside core hours.

5.3 Biometric Attendance

Attendance at NexaCore is **automatically logged via ID card taps at facility turnstiles**. There is no separate attendance register, timesheet sign-in or manual punch process for office attendance. The biometric turnstile record synchronises to the HRMS (Workday), where employees and managers can view daily attendance, monthly summaries and exception reports.

- Tap your ID card on entry and on exit. A missing exit tap can cause the day to be recorded as incomplete.
- Tailgating through a turnstile without tapping means your attendance is not recorded, even though you are physically present. It is also a security violation under Section 4.10.
- Employees working from home under an approved hybrid arrangement are marked present through the HRMS work-location declaration, not through turnstile taps.
- Employees travelling on approved company business are marked present against the travel request in the HRMS.

5.4 Late Coming

The late-coming rule is applied automatically by the HRMS and is not subject to manager discretion after the fact.

WARNING: Swiping in after 10:30 AM without prior flexi-hour approval will automatically deduct 0.5 Casual Leave (CL). If the Casual Leave balance is exhausted, the deduction is taken from Earned Leave (EL).

Table 5-2: Attendance Rules and Automatic System Actions

Scenario	System Action	Employee Action Required
Swipe in before 10:30 AM	Recorded as on-time	None.
Swipe in after 10:30 AM with prior flexi-hour approval on record	Recorded as on-time under the approved flexi schedule	Ensure the flexi-hour schedule is approved in the HRMS before the day in question.
Swipe in after 10:30 AM without prior approval	Automatic deduction of 0.5 Casual Leave	If the delay was unavoidable, raise an attendance correction with supporting explanation (Section 5.8).
Casual Leave balance exhausted at time of late-coming	Deduction is taken from Earned Leave	Monitor your CL and EL balances in the HRMS.
Fewer than 4.5 hours worked in a calendar day	Recorded as a half-day	Apply half-day leave in the HRMS for the remaining portion.
No swipe recorded and no approved leave or WFH declaration	Recorded as unplanned absence	Inform your manager immediately and regularise through the HRMS.

5.5 Flexi-Hours

NexaCore supports flexible scheduling. **Employees may set their own 9-hour schedules, provided they are present during the core hours of 10:00 AM to 04:00 PM.** A flexi-hour schedule must be recorded and approved in the HRMS by the reporting manager before it takes effect; it cannot be applied retrospectively to excuse a late swipe.

EXAMPLE: A Backend Engineering associate at the Western Delivery Center, Pune, requests a flexi schedule of **10:15 AM to 07:15 PM** to accommodate a commute constraint. The manager declines this schedule: although it is a full nine hours, it begins after 10:00 AM and therefore does not cover the complete core-hours window. The manager instead approves **10:00 AM to 07:00 PM**, which is nine hours and fully covers core hours. A schedule of **08:30 AM to 05:30 PM** would be equally acceptable, as would **09:30 AM to 06:30 PM**.

5.6 Half-Day

A half-day is defined as **working fewer than 4.5 hours in a calendar day**. Half-days must be applied for in the HRMS against an available leave balance. Where an employee works fewer than 4.5 hours without an approved half-day application, the HRMS records the shortfall and the reporting manager is prompted to regularise the record.

5.7 Absence

Planned absence must be applied for and approved in the HRMS in advance. For unplanned absence — illness, a family emergency or a transport disruption — the employee must inform their reporting manager as early as possible on the day, ideally before 10:00 AM, and must regularise the absence in the HRMS on return by applying the appropriate leave type. Repeated unplanned absence without notification is treated as a conduct matter and is addressed under Section 7.9 and the Code of Conduct.

5.8 Attendance Corrections

Genuine attendance discrepancies do occur — a malfunctioning turnstile, a forgotten exit tap, a card that fails to read, or a day spent entirely at a client site. These are corrected through an **Attendance Correction request in the HRMS**, routed to the reporting manager for approval.

1. Open the Attendance module in the HRMS and locate the affected date.
2. Raise an Attendance Correction request, selecting the reason (card malfunction, client visit, missed exit tap, approved off-site work, or other).
3. Provide a short factual explanation and attach supporting evidence where available, such as a client meeting invitation or a Security Desk incident reference.
4. Submit for reporting-manager approval. Requests must be raised **within 7 calendar days** of the affected date.

5. Approved corrections update the attendance record and reverse any automatic leave deduction.

NOTE: Attendance corrections are intended for genuine system or situational discrepancies. They are not a mechanism for retrospectively excusing habitual late arrival. Managers are expected to review correction patterns during performance discussions.

5.9 Work Calendar

The NexaCore work calendar runs Monday to Friday, excluding the ten published public holidays. The financial year runs from 1 April to 31 March and governs promotions, increments and variable pay. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December and governs all leave accrual and carry-forward calculations. Employees should note the distinction: **leave balances reset in January, not in April.**

5.10 Holiday Calendar 2026

Employees receive **10 paid public holidays per calendar year**. The 2026 calendar is published below and is also available in the HRMS.

Table 5-3: NexaCore Company Holiday Calendar 2026

#	Holiday	Date	Notes
1	Republic Day	January 26	National holiday
2	Holi	March 4	Festival holiday
3	Labour Day	May 1	National holiday
4	Independence Day	August 15	National holiday
5	Gandhi Jayanti	October 2	National holiday
6	Dussehra	October 19	Festival holiday
7	Diwali (Day 1)	November 8	Festival holiday — two days observed
8	Diwali (Day 2)	November 9	Festival holiday — two days observed
9	Christmas	December 25	Festival holiday
10	Floating Holiday	Employee Choice	Must be applied as Earned Leave (EL) via the HRMS.

NOTE ON THE FLOATING HOLIDAY: The tenth holiday is an employee-choice floating holiday. It is not automatically granted — it must be applied for as Earned Leave through the HRMS and approved by the reporting manager, like any other planned absence. Employees who do not have an Earned Leave balance (Interns at L1 and Contractors at C1) cannot avail the floating holiday.

5.11 Cross-Reference to the Leave Policy

This section governs attendance and working hours only. All matters of leave entitlement, accrual, application workflow, approval routing, carry-forward and encashment are governed by the **Leave Policy**, owned by the Employee Success (HRBP) team. The summary below is provided for orientation; the Leave Policy is the controlling document.

Table 5-4: Annual Leave Entitlement Summary (Leave Year: 1 January - 31 December)

Leave Type	FTE (L2-L6)	Interns (L1)	Contractors (C1)	Carry Forward Rules
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	6 days	0 days	Lapses at year-end
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	0 days	0 days	Maximum 10 days carry forward
Sick Leave (SL)	6 days	3 days	0 days	Lapses at year-end
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Not applicable	Not applicable	Cannot be carried forward
Paternity Leave	2 weeks	Not applicable	Not applicable	Lapses 6 months post-birth
Bereavement Leave	3 days	3 days	0 days	Incident-based

6. Dress Code

The NexaCore dress code is situational rather than uniform. It is designed to be comfortable for day-to-day engineering and corporate work while ensuring that the company presents professionally to clients and that safety requirements are met without exception in technical environments.

Table 6-1: NexaCore Situational Dress Code Summary

Situation	Required Standard	Description
Standard (Monday to Thursday)	Smart Casuals	Collared shirts, polos, tailored trousers, chinos, modest dresses.
Friday	Casuals	Jeans, company t-shirts, sneakers.
Client visits and client-facing meetings	Formal Business Attire	Suits, blazers, ties optional, formal footwear.
Interview panels	Formal Business Attire	Suits, blazers, ties optional, formal footwear.
Hackathons	Relaxed Casual	Hoodies allowed.
Server rooms and hardware labs	Safety Exception (applies at all times)	Open-toe shoes, flip-flops and shorts are strictly prohibited.

6.1 Smart Casuals (Monday to Thursday)

Smart Casuals is the standard dress code from Monday to Thursday at all NexaCore locations. The intent is professional but comfortable: an employee should be able to join an unscheduled internal video call or walk a visiting colleague through the office without needing to change.

6.2 Friday Casuals

Casuals apply on Fridays. Jeans, company t-shirts and sneakers are acceptable. The Friday relaxation does not apply if the employee has a client meeting, an interview panel or an external visit scheduled that day — in those cases the higher standard applies for the whole day.

6.3 Client Meetings

Formal business attire is required for all client-facing meetings, whether held at a NexaCore office, at a client site or on video. This reflects the Customer Centricity value: clients should experience the same standard of professionalism regardless of location or day of the week.

6.4 Interview Panels

Employees serving on an interview panel must wear formal business attire. Candidates form their first impression of NexaCore from the panel, and the standard applies equally to technical and non-technical interviewers, and to panels conducted over video.

6.5 Hackathons

Internal hackathons operate under relaxed casual dress. Hoodies are allowed. The safety exception for server rooms and hardware labs continues to apply during hackathons without exception — participants working in a hardware lab must wear closed footwear and full-length trousers.

6.6 Laboratories and Server Rooms

Server rooms and hardware labs are technical environments with real physical hazards: heavy equipment, cabling, sharp rack edges, and floor-level power infrastructure.

SAFETY EXCEPTION — NO EXCEPTIONS PERMITTED: Open-toe shoes, flip-flops and shorts are strictly prohibited in all server rooms and hardware labs at all times. This applies on Fridays, during hackathons, and outside standard working hours. Employees who arrive at a lab inappropriately dressed will be refused entry by the on-duty technician or Facilities personnel.

6.7 Safety Rules Relating to Dress

- Closed footwear is mandatory in all server rooms and hardware labs.
- Full-length trousers are mandatory in all server rooms and hardware labs.
- Loose jewellery, scarves and lanyards should be secured before working inside an equipment rack.
- Appropriate athletic footwear is required in the 2nd Floor gymnasium; open-toe shoes and flip-flops are not permitted.
- The ID card must remain visible at all times regardless of what is being worn.

6.8 Examples of Acceptable and Unacceptable Clothing

Table 6-2: Dress Code Examples by Situation

Situation	Acceptable	Not Acceptable
Monday to Thursday (Smart Casuals)	Collared shirt with chinos; polo shirt with tailored trousers; modest dress with a cardigan; clean loafers or smart shoes.	Sleeveless vests; beachwear; visibly torn or distressed jeans; flip-flops; sportswear such as track pants or gym shorts.
Friday (Casuals)	Jeans with a company t-shirt; sneakers; casual button-down shirt.	Shorts in a hardware lab or server room; flip-flops in any technical area; clothing carrying offensive slogans or imagery.
Client meeting or interview panel	Business suit; blazer with formal trousers or skirt; formal shirt; formal closed footwear; tie optional.	Jeans; sneakers; company t-shirts; hoodies; casual sandals — even if the meeting falls on a Friday.
Hackathon	Hoodie with jeans; company t-shirt; sneakers; comfortable layered clothing.	Open-toe footwear or shorts if any part of the hackathon involves the hardware lab or server room.
Server room or hardware lab	Closed shoes with a firm sole; full-length trousers; short or long sleeves; secured lanyard.	Sandals; flip-flops; open-toe shoes of any kind; shorts; loose trailing scarves near rack equipment.

NOTE: Where an employee is uncertain whether a garment meets the standard, the reasonable test is whether it would be appropriate if a client walked into the office unannounced. Employees with religious or medical dress requirements should speak to their HR Business Partner; NexaCore accommodates such requirements in line with the Inclusive Excellence value.

7. Workplace Conduct

This section sets out day-to-day behavioural expectations at NexaCore. It complements — and does not replace — the **Code of Conduct**, owned by the Legal & Compliance Team, which governs ethical expectations, conflict of interest, anti-harassment (POSH) and formal disciplinary procedures.

7.1 Professional Behaviour

Professional behaviour at NexaCore means doing what you said you would do, communicating clearly when you cannot, and treating every colleague, client, contractor and visitor with the same courtesy. Employees are expected to arrive prepared, meet committed timelines or flag slippage early, take ownership of mistakes without deflection, and represent NexaCore accurately in every external interaction. Professional behaviour applies equally in the office, on Slack, on video calls, at client sites and at company events.

7.2 Respect in the Workplace

NexaCore has zero tolerance for harassment, bullying, intimidation, discrimination or retaliation. This applies to conduct based on gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, caste, ethnicity, nationality, disability, age, marital status, language or any other personal characteristic. It applies to overt conduct and to sustained patterns of exclusion or belittling that create a hostile environment.

HOW TO REPORT: Matters relating to **Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)** are reported directly to the **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)**, with secondary escalation to the Legal & Compliance Team and the CHRO. Employees are not required to raise POSH concerns with their line manager first. Retaliation against a complainant or a witness is itself a disciplinary offence. See the Escalation Matrix in Section 10.9.

7.3 Communication

NexaCore is a distributed company; clear written communication is a core professional skill here, not an optional one. The following norms apply.

- **Choose the right channel.** Slack for quick coordination, email for formal external and record-worthy communication, Jira for work items, Confluence for decisions and documentation. Slack is not a system of record.
- **Write for the reader who was not there.** Provide context in the first two lines: what this is about, what you need, and by when.
- **Respect availability.** Do not expect immediate responses outside core hours (10:00 AM to 04:00 PM) or outside standard working hours. If something is genuinely urgent, say so explicitly and say why.
- **Assume good intent.** Written text loses tone. Where a message reads as abrupt, ask before reacting.
- **Never share confidential information externally.** Client names, code snippets and internal data must not be posted on social media or shared outside approved channels. See Section 13.7 and the Information Security Policy.

7.4 Email Etiquette

1. Write a specific subject line that identifies the topic and the action required.
2. State the ask in the first paragraph; provide background below it.
3. Address the email to those who must act; use CC for those who need awareness only.
4. Use "Reply All" only when every recipient genuinely needs the reply.
5. Never use BCC to conceal a recipient from the visible audience in an internal discussion.
6. Proofread before sending, particularly for client-facing email.
7. Do not forward internal email chains externally without checking the full thread for confidential content.
8. Set an out-of-office message with an alternate contact whenever you are on leave.

7.5 Meeting Etiquette

- Every meeting must have a stated purpose and, where a decision is expected, a named decision-maker.
- Schedule inside core hours (10:00 AM to 04:00 PM) so hybrid and flexi-hour colleagues can attend.
- Book only the room capacity you need, and release the booking promptly if the meeting is cancelled.
- Join on time. Arriving five minutes late to a thirty-minute meeting costs the group meaningful time.
- Record decisions and action items on Confluence, with an owner and a date against each action.
- Actively invite input from remote participants and from quieter attendees.
- End on time, or explicitly agree to extend.

7.6 Office Cleanliness

NexaCore operates a clear-desk expectation. Employees are asked to clear their workspace of documents, notes and personal items at the end of the working day; this supports both cleanliness and information security, since printed material containing client information must never be left unattended. Food should be consumed in the 4th Floor cafeteria or designated breakout areas rather than at desks near equipment. Meeting rooms must be left clear, with whiteboards wiped and chairs replaced.

7.7 Noise Levels

NexaCore workspaces are open-plan and shared. Employees should take calls and video meetings in booths or meeting rooms rather than at their desk, use headphones for any audio, keep informal conversations away from focused-work pods, and keep device notification sounds muted. The wellness and quiet rooms on the 2nd Floor at the Global Headquarters are available for focused work and for calls requiring privacy.

7.8 Inclusive Workplace

Inclusive Excellence is a NexaCore core value, and inclusion is treated as a set of daily behaviours rather than an annual initiative. In practice this means scheduling meetings inside core hours so that colleagues with caregiving commitments or hybrid schedules are not systematically excluded; ensuring that design reviews and retrospectives actively invite quieter and remote participants; using clear language rather than idiom-heavy shorthand in a multilingual workplace; accommodating religious and medical dress requirements; and ensuring that facility access, meeting formats and social events are accessible to employees with disabilities. Employees who observe exclusionary behaviour should raise it with their manager or their HR Business Partner.

7.9 Conflict Resolution

Disagreement is normal in engineering and delivery work and is often productive. Unresolved interpersonal conflict is not. NexaCore expects conflict to be addressed early and at the lowest effective level.

1. **Direct conversation.** Where it is safe and appropriate, speak to the other person directly and privately, focusing on the specific behaviour and its impact rather than on character.
2. **Involve the reporting manager.** If direct conversation does not resolve the matter, or is not appropriate, raise it with your direct manager (L4 or above), who is the first point of contact for general grievances.
3. **Escalate to the HR Business Partner.** The HRBP provides a neutral facilitated discussion and, where needed, a formal investigation.
4. **Specialised routes.** Conflict of interest matters go to the Legal & Compliance Team; information breaches go to the CISO; POSH matters go directly to the Internal Complaints Committee. These routes bypass the line manager entirely and are set out in the Escalation Matrix in Section 10.9.

NOTE: Formal disciplinary procedures, including warnings, investigation protocols and grounds for termination, are defined in the **Code of Conduct**, owned by the Legal & Compliance Team. This handbook does not restate them.

8. Learning and Development

NexaCore invests in learning because the Agile Innovation value depends on it: a company that adapts, iterates and invents continuously requires people whose skills are continuously current. Learning and Development at NexaCore is delivered through four channels — self-directed platform learning, structured mentorship, funded certification, and sponsored conference attendance — and is directly connected to the promotion process described in Section 3.10.

8.1 Training and Onboarding Learning

Every new joiner completes a structured onboarding learning path assigned in the HRMS during the first week. The path covers the NexaCore mission, vision and values; the eight core governance documents; mandatory Information Security awareness training; mandatory POSH awareness training; and a role-specific technical or functional module assigned by the reporting manager. Mandatory modules must be completed within the first 30 days of joining. Refresher training on Information Security and POSH is assigned annually to all employees, interns and contractors.

8.2 Mentorship

Every new joiner is assigned a buddy on Day 1 to help navigate the first few weeks — where things are, how teams work, and who to ask. Beyond that, NexaCore operates a formal mentorship programme in which employees at L2 and L3 are matched with a mentor at L4 or above from outside their direct reporting line, so that mentoring conversations remain separate from performance evaluation. L1 Interns are assigned a mentor at L3 or L4 in addition to their reporting manager. Mentorship pairings are recorded in the HRMS and are reviewed every six months.

8.3 Learning Platforms

All employees at every grade — **L1 through L6, including contractors** — receive enterprise access to **Udemy for Business** and **LinkedIn Learning**. Access is provisioned automatically against the corporate email address during onboarding and is available through the internal portal using single sign-on. There is no separate approval or cost recovery for platform learning; employees are encouraged to use it freely, and managers are expected to protect time for it.

8.4 Certification Support

NexaCore funds professional certification through an annual certification budget. The budget is per employee, per financial year, and does not carry forward.

Table 8-1: Annual Certification Budget by Job Grade

Grade	Annual Budget	Conditions
L1 (Intern) and C1 (Contractor)	₹0	Not eligible for the certification budget. Platform access to Udemy for Business and LinkedIn Learning is still provided.
L2 and L3	₹25,000 per year	Must be pre-approved by an L4 or above and must be relevant to the employee's role.
L4 and above	₹50,000 per year	Must be pre-approved by an L4 or above and must be relevant to the employee's role.

WARNING: Certification expenses claimed **without prior approval** will not be reimbursed. Pre-approval must be recorded in the HRMS before the certification is booked or paid for. Claims must be submitted within **30 days** of the expense with a valid receipt, in line with the Expense & Reimbursement Policy.

Certifications matter for more than skill development: the certifications listed in the Promotion Matrix (Table 3-3) are documented eligibility requirements for progression. An L2 Associate seeking promotion to L3 is expected to hold a certification such as AWS Developer or CKA, recorded in the HRMS. An L3 Senior seeking promotion to L4 is expected to hold a certification such as PMP, Scrum Master or CISSP.

8.5 Conference Policy

Employees at **grade L3 and above** are eligible for **one company-sponsored domestic technology conference per year**, such as AWS Summit or Google Cloud Next. Approval is routed via the **VP of Engineering, Rohan Gupta**.

Table 8-2: Conference Sponsorship Eligibility and Approval

Parameter	Standard
Eligibility	Grade L3 and above
Frequency	One company-sponsored domestic technology conference per year
Examples	AWS Summit, Google Cloud Next
Approval Route	VP of Engineering (Rohan Gupta)
Associated Travel	Domestic travel rules apply: raise the travel request at least 7 days in advance; L4 Manager approval; Economy class flights for all grades. Refer to the Travel Policy.
Expected Output	Attendees are expected to share key learnings with their team through a Confluence write-up or an internal session.

8.6 Career Growth

The NexaCore career ladder runs from L1 to L6, with a parallel contractual track at C1. Progression from L2 to L3 typically recognises depth of technical or functional expertise. Progression from L3 to L4 marks the transition into mid-level management or principal-level individual

contribution. Progression from L4 to L5 marks entry into senior management, and from L5 to L6 into executive leadership, which requires Board approval. Employees who wish to change function rather than level should use the Internal Job Posting programme described in Section 3.9.

8.7 Performance Culture and Review Cycles

NexaCore runs two formal review cycles each year, both administered through the HRMS.

Table 8-3: NexaCore Performance Review Cycles

Cycle	Month	Purpose and Outcome
Mid-Year Review	October	Developmental focus. No compensation changes are made in this cycle. Used to recalibrate goals, identify development needs and course-correct early.
Annual Review	March	Performance ratings are locked. Influences the April increment cycle and the annual promotion cycle effective 1 April.

Table 8-4: NexaCore Performance Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Meaning and Consequence
1	Unacceptable	Requires an immediate Performance Improvement Plan (PIP), a 60-day corrective action plan.
2	Needs Improvement	Performance falls short of role expectations. Structured development plan agreed with the manager.
3	Meets Expectations	The standard rating. Role expectations are consistently delivered.
4	Exceeds Expectations	Promotion eligible. This is the minimum rating required for promotion consideration.
5	Outstanding	Exceptional impact well beyond role expectations.

NOTE: Variable pay and bonuses are paid bi-annually in the **October and April payroll cycles**, prorated based on individual performance ratings. Promotion requires a minimum rating of **"4 - Exceeds Expectations"**, a minimum of **18 months in the current grade**, a direct manager recommendation at L4 or above, and HR Business Partner approval. Full details of the review methodology, goal-setting framework and calibration process are maintained in the **Performance Review** documentation on the HRMS.

9. Technology at NexaCore

This section introduces the core systems every NexaCore employee uses. It is an orientation guide only. **Security rules governing these systems — passwords, VPN usage, device management, data handling and access control — are set out in the Information Security Policy, owned by CISO Ananya Rao.** Employees must read that policy in full; this section does not substitute for it.

Table 9-1: Core NexaCore Systems and Their Purpose

System	Owner	Primary Use
HRMS (Workday)	HRMS Product Team / HR	Leave, payroll, performance, promotion, resignation, letter requests, document library
Corporate Email	IT Support & Asset Management	Formal internal and external communication; calendar and meeting-room booking
Slack	IT Support & Asset Management	Day-to-day team coordination and informal communication
GitHub Enterprise	Engineering & IT	Source code, version control, code review and technical design records
Jira	Engineering & IT / Operations	Work items, sprints, defects and delivery tracking
Confluence	All departments	Documentation, decisions, meeting records and the NexaCore Knowledge Base
VPN	Security Engineering	Secure remote access to internal systems
IT Service Desk	IT Support & Asset Management	Hardware, software, access and incident tickets
Internal Portal	IT Support & Asset Management	Single sign-on gateway to all systems, policy library and learning platforms
Envoy	Facilities & Workspace Management	Visitor pre-registration and check-in

9.1 HRMS (Workday)

The HRMS is the Human Resources Management System and the single system of record for the employee lifecycle. Employees use it to apply for leave, view attendance and leave balances, raise attendance corrections, submit expense claims, complete performance reviews, apply for Internal Job Postings, submit resignation, download payslips and tax documents, request letters, and access the document library containing all eight core governance documents. Managers use it to approve requests, complete reviews and submit promotion recommendations. The HRMS is owned by the HRMS Product Team within Product & AI Development, with functional ownership held by Human Resources.

9.2 Corporate Email

Every employee receives a NexaCore corporate email address on Day 1. Corporate email is the formal channel for external communication and for internal communication that needs to be recorded. It is also the calendar system used for meeting scheduling and meeting-room booking as described in Section 4.6. Email etiquette expectations are set out in Section 7.4.

9.3 Slack

Slack is the day-to-day coordination tool at NexaCore, organised into team channels, project channels and announcement channels. Slack is designed for speed, not for permanence: decisions reached on Slack must be written up on Confluence, and work items must be raised in Jira.

Employees should respect availability norms — responses cannot be expected outside core hours — and should never post client names, credentials or code snippets in channels that are broader than the work requires.

9.4 GitHub Enterprise

GitHub Enterprise hosts all NexaCore source code, including client project repositories, internal platform code and infrastructure-as-code definitions. Access is granted by repository based on team membership and is requested through the IT Service Desk. All code changes go through pull request and peer review; direct commits to protected branches are disabled. Repository ownership must be transferred as part of the exit checklist described in Section 3.12.

9.5 Jira

Jira is the work-tracking system used across Engineering & IT, Product & AI Development, Operations and Customer Success. Every unit of work has a Jira ticket with a single named owner. Sprint planning, defect tracking, release management and delivery reporting all run through Jira. Open Jira items must be closed or reassigned before an employee's Last Working Day.

9.6 Confluence

Confluence is the NexaCore documentation platform and hosts the NexaCore Knowledge Base, including a mirrored copy of the eight core governance documents and the complete company glossary. Teams use Confluence for architecture decision records, runbooks, meeting notes, onboarding guides and process documentation. The operating principle is simple: if a decision is not on Confluence, it is not a decision.

9.7 VPN

The Virtual Private Network is the mandatory secure tunnel for remote access to company systems. VPN is **mandatory for accessing internal staging servers, the HRMS and the codebase when outside the office network**. It is provisioned on the company laptop during the Day 1 IT asset handover.

WARNING: Employees working from home must connect through the VPN and must use a secured private Wi-Fi network. **Public Wi-Fi — cafes, airports, hotels — must never be used without the VPN active.** Complete remote-access security requirements are defined in the Information Security Policy.

9.8 IT Helpdesk and Service Desk

The IT Service Desk, operated by IT Support & Asset Management, is the single route for all technology requests and incidents: hardware faults, software installation requests, access provisioning, VPN issues, account lockouts and asset return. Employees cannot install unapproved software and do not hold administrative rights on company laptops; all software requests must be routed through an IT Service Desk ticket.

Table 9-2: Common IT Service Desk Request Types

Request Type	Notes
Hardware fault or replacement	Raise a ticket with the asset tag. Refresh cycles are defined in Table 9-3.
Software installation	Administrative rights are locked. All installations require an approved ticket.
Access provisioning (GitHub, Jira, Confluence, shared drives)	Requires manager approval routed through the ticket.
VPN or connectivity issue	Include the error message and your location at the time of failure.
Lost or stolen laptop	Must be reported to IT Support within 4 hours. A police FIR is required for replacement.
Asset return on exit	Surrender all assets by 4:00 PM on the Last Working Day.

9.9 Hardware Allocation and Refresh

Hardware is assigned strictly on the basis of department and job grade. Employees may only use company-issued laptops for NexaCore work.

Table 9-3: Role-Based Laptop Specifications and Refresh Cycles

Role / Department	Standard Hardware Issued	Refresh Cycle
Intern (L1)	Dell Latitude 3000 (i5, 16GB RAM)	Not applicable — returned at end of term
QA / Operations	Lenovo ThinkPad T-Series (i7, 16GB RAM)	3 Years
Backend / Frontend Development	Apple MacBook Pro 14" (M3 Pro, 32GB RAM)	3 Years
AI / Document Intelligence Team	Apple MacBook Pro 16" (M3 Max, 64GB RAM)	2.5 Years
HR / Finance / C-Suite	Apple MacBook Air 15" (M3, 16GB RAM)	3 Years

Table 9-4: Hardware Replacement Matrix

Asset	Standard Refresh Cycle	Replacement if Lost or Stolen
Laptop (Standard)	3 Years	IT Approval + Police FIR
Laptop (High-Compute)	3 Years (L3+ Engineering only)	IT Approval + Police FIR
Monitor (Office)	5 Years	IT Approval
Peripherals (Mouse / Keyboard)	1 Year	Manager Approval

9.10 Internal Portal

The internal portal is the single sign-on gateway to all NexaCore systems. From the portal, employees can reach the HRMS, Slack, Jira, Confluence, GitHub Enterprise, the IT Service Desk, Udemy for Business and LinkedIn Learning, and the complete policy library containing all eight core

9.11 Cross-Reference to the Information Security Policy

IMPORTANT: This section is an orientation guide to NexaCore systems and deliberately does not go deep into security. The following are governed in full by the **Information Security Policy**, owned by CISO Ananya Rao, which every employee must read: password standards (minimum 14 characters, alphanumeric with special characters, mandatory rotation every 90 days); the prohibition on personal USB drives and external hard drives, enforced through MDM; the restriction on software installation and administrative rights; the four-hour reporting window for a lost laptop and the potential 20% liability for depreciated cost in cases of gross negligence; VPN requirements; and the prohibition on posting confidential company data, code snippets or client names on social media.

10. Employee Support

NexaCore provides defined support functions for every category of employee need. Employees should use the correct function rather than the most familiar contact, and should follow the escalation path in Section 10.9 where a matter is not resolved at the first level.

10.1 Human Resources Support

Human Resources is organised into three teams. **Talent Acquisition** handles recruitment, offers and candidate experience. **Employee Success (HRBPs)** is the day-to-day support function for existing employees, covering onboarding, probation, confirmation, transfers, grievances, performance process support, letter requests and exit. **Payroll & Benefits** handles salary, tax declarations, Provident Fund, gratuity, insurance enrolment and Full and Final Settlement. The department is led by CHRO Ritika Sharma. Every employee has a named HR Business Partner recorded in the HRMS.

10.2 Finance Support

Finance, led by CFO Vikram Desai with Director of Finance Siddharth Kapoor, covers accounts payable and receivable, vendor payments, budget management, and ownership of both the Expense & Reimbursement Policy and the Travel Policy. Expense claims are submitted through the HRMS **within 30 days of the expense** with valid GST receipts, and are approved by the reporting manager before Finance processing.

10.3 Payroll Support

Payroll is handled by the Payroll & Benefits team within Human Resources.

Table 10-1: Payroll and Compensation Logistics

Item	Standard
Salary Credit Date	Credited on the last working day of every month .
Variable Pay / Bonus	Paid bi-annually in the October and April payroll cycles, prorated based on individual performance ratings.
Provident Fund (PF)	12% of Basic Salary is deducted as the employee contribution, with an equal matching contribution from the company.
Gratuity	Calculated at 15 days of basic salary for every completed year of service . Payable only after completing 5 continuous years of employment.
Tax Declarations	The IT declaration window opens on the HRMS from 1 January to 15 February for submission of rent receipts, 80C and 80D proofs.
Payslips and Tax Documents	Available for download from the HRMS at any time.

WARNING: The tax declaration window closes on **15 February**. Proofs submitted after this date cannot be processed in the same financial year, which may result in higher tax deduction at source. Employees are responsible for submitting complete proofs within the window.

10.4 Facilities Support

The Facilities & Workspace Management team, headed at the Global Headquarters by **Amit Verma, Facilities Manager (L4)**, handles workspace allocation, parking stickers, meeting-room escalations, access-card replacement, building maintenance, cafeteria services, gym waivers and visitor management through the Envoy app.

10.5 IT Helpdesk Support

The IT Service Desk, operated by IT Support & Asset Management, is the single route for all technology requests as described in Section 9.8. Employees must raise a ticket rather than contacting individual IT staff directly, so that requests are tracked, prioritised and auditable.

CRITICAL: **Loss of a laptop must be reported to IT Support within 4 hours.** A police FIR is required before a replacement is issued. Where loss results from gross negligence, the employee may be liable for **20% of the depreciated cost**. See the Information Security Policy.

10.6 Security Support

Two distinct security functions operate at NexaCore, and employees should be clear about which one to contact. **Physical security** is handled by the Security Desk at each facility, staffed 24/7 on the Ground Floor adjacent to Reception; it handles access-card issues, after-hours entry, incident logging and visitor escorting. **Information security** is owned by the Security & Compliance department under CISO Ananya Rao, comprising Security Engineering and Risk & Governance; it handles suspected data breaches, phishing reports, access reviews and security policy questions.

WARNING: Any suspected information breach — a phishing email that was clicked, data sent to the wrong recipient, a lost device containing client data, or unauthorised access — must be reported **immediately** to the IT Security Officer (CISO), with secondary escalation to the Legal Team. Delayed reporting significantly increases harm. Employees are never penalised for reporting a genuine mistake promptly.

10.7 Medical Support

The Medical Room at the Global Headquarters is located on the Ground Floor, East Wing, and is staffed by a registered nurse 24 hours a day, seven days a week. It provides first aid, basic medication, a rest facility and ambulance coordination. Full-Time Employees at grades L2 to L6 are additionally covered by corporate insurance as summarised in Section 13.3, including Group Medical Cover of ₹5,00,000. Interns and contractors are not covered under corporate health plans but have full access to the on-site Medical Room and all emergency support.

10.8 Emergency Contacts

Table 10-2: NexaCore Emergency and Support Contact Directory

Situation	Contact	Channel
Medical emergency on site	Medical Room nurse (Ground Floor, East Wing) and Security Desk	In person or facility emergency line; available 24/7
Fire or evacuation	Fire alarm call point, then Security Desk	Activate nearest call point; assemble at the North Lawn
Physical security incident or access issue	Security Desk (Ground Floor, adjacent to Reception)	In person; staffed 24/7
Lost or stolen laptop	IT Support & Asset Management	IT Service Desk ticket within 4 hours , plus police FIR
Suspected information breach	IT Security Officer (CISO) — Ananya Rao	Immediate escalation; secondary escalation to the Legal Team
Harassment (POSH)	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	Direct to ICC; secondary escalation to Legal & Compliance and CHRO
Conflict of interest	Legal & Compliance Team	Direct; secondary escalation to CHRO Ritika Sharma
General grievance	Direct Manager (L4 or above)	Direct conversation; secondary escalation to HR Business Partner
Facilities issue (building, parking, cafeteria, access card)	Facilities & Workspace Management — Amit Verma (Bengaluru)	Facilities request ticket
Payroll, tax or insurance query	Payroll & Benefits team	HRMS ticket

10.9 Escalation Matrix

The escalation matrix defines the correct first point of contact and secondary escalation for conduct and compliance matters. **Employees are not required to raise POSH, conflict-of-interest or information-breach matters with their line manager first** — these routes deliberately bypass the reporting line.

Table 10-3: Escalation Matrix for Code of Conduct and Harassment Matters

Violation Type	First Point of Contact	Secondary Escalation
General Grievance	Direct Manager (L4+)	HR Business Partner
Conflict of Interest	Legal & Compliance Team	Chief HR Officer (CHRO)
Information Breach	IT Security Officer (CISO)	Legal Team
POSH (Harassment)	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	Legal & CHRO

NOTE: Retaliation against any employee who raises a concern in good faith, or who participates as a witness in an investigation, is itself a disciplinary offence under the Code of Conduct. NexaCore treats the protection of complainants as non-negotiable.

11. Health and Safety

NexaCore Technologies is responsible for providing a safe workplace, and every employee, intern, contractor and visitor is responsible for behaving safely within it. This section describes what to do in an emergency at any NexaCore facility. Employees should read it before they need it — the time to learn the location of the nearest emergency exit is not during an evacuation.

11.1 Fire Safety

Fire safety equipment at every NexaCore facility includes smoke and heat detectors, sprinkler systems, fire extinguishers and manual alarm call points positioned at each stairwell entrance. At the Global Headquarters, **emergency exits are located at the East and West wings of every floor.**

- Learn the location of the two nearest emergency exits from your regular workstation on your first day.
- Never obstruct an emergency exit, stairwell, extinguisher or alarm call point with boxes, furniture or equipment.
- Never prop open a fire door. Fire doors contain smoke and buy evacuation time.
- If you discover a fire, activate the nearest alarm call point first, then evacuate. Do not attempt to fight a fire beyond a small, contained ignition that you are trained and confident to handle.
- Fire drills are conducted periodically by the Facilities & Workspace Management team. Participation is mandatory for everyone in the building, including visitors and contractors.

11.2 Emergency Evacuation Procedure

The designated fire assembly point for the Global Headquarters is the **North Lawn**. The evacuation procedure below applies to all occupants without exception.

Table 11-1: Emergency Evacuation Procedure

Step	Action	Detail
1	Stop work immediately	On hearing the evacuation alarm, stop what you are doing. Do not save files, finish a call or collect belongings.
2	Lock your screen	Lock the laptop screen if you can do so in one action. Do not delay evacuation for any device.
3	Leave by the nearest emergency exit	Emergency exits are at the East and West wings of every floor. Use the exit nearest to you, not the one you normally use.
4	Use stairs, never lifts	Lifts must not be used during an evacuation under any circumstances.
5	Escort your visitors	Hosts remain responsible for their visitors during an evacuation and must guide them out and to the assembly point.
6	Assemble at the North Lawn	Proceed directly to the North Lawn. Do not stop in the lobby, the car park or the road outside.
7	Report to the roll call	Report your presence to your floor warden or the Facilities team so that the roll call is accurate.
8	Do not re-enter	Do not re-enter the building for any reason until the Facilities team or emergency services declare it safe.

WARNING: An inaccurate roll call causes emergency responders to search a building unnecessarily, putting them at risk. **Always report to the roll call at the North Lawn, and never leave the site during an evacuation without informing a floor warden.**

11.3 Medical Emergencies

For any medical emergency on site, contact the **Medical Room (Ground Floor, East Wing)** and the Security Desk immediately. The Medical Room is staffed by a registered nurse 24 hours a day, seven days a week, and coordinates ambulance transfer where required.

1. Call the Security Desk and the Medical Room. State the exact floor, wing and nature of the emergency.
2. Do not move a person who has collapsed, fallen from height or may have a spinal injury, unless they are in immediate further danger.
3. Clear space around the person and keep onlookers back.
4. Send someone to the lift lobby to direct the nurse or paramedics to the exact location.
5. Stay with the person until qualified help arrives.
6. Ensure the incident is logged with the Medical Room nurse afterwards, so that a record exists.

11.4 Accidents and Injury Reporting

Every workplace accident and near-miss must be reported, however minor it appears. Reporting a near-miss — a trailing cable, a wet floor without signage, a loose rack panel, a faulty chair — is the primary mechanism by which NexaCore prevents a future injury. Report the incident to the Medical Room nurse for any injury, and to the Facilities & Workspace Management team for the hazard itself. Incidents occurring in server rooms or hardware labs must additionally be reported to the IT Service Desk. Employees are never penalised for reporting a hazard or a near-miss in good faith.

11.5 Natural Disasters

Table 11-2: Response to Natural Disaster and Severe Weather Events

Event	Required Response
Earthquake	Drop, cover and hold under a sturdy desk away from windows and tall furniture. Do not run outside during shaking. When the shaking stops, evacuate by the stairs to the North Lawn assembly point and await instructions.
Flooding or severe rain	Move away from basement levels — Basements 1, 2 and 3 — to higher floors. Do not attempt to retrieve a vehicle from a flooding basement. Follow Facilities instructions on shelter or release.
Severe storm or high wind	Move away from windows and glazed façades to the building core. Do not evacuate into open ground unless instructed.
Power failure	Emergency lighting will activate. Remain at your workstation unless instructed otherwise. Do not use lifts. Save and secure work if the laptop battery permits.
Civil disruption or external incident	Follow the Security Desk instruction, which may be to shelter in place rather than to evacuate. Do not leave the building against a shelter-in-place instruction.

NOTE: During a severe weather event or civil disruption, NexaCore may declare a temporary full work-from-home arrangement for a specific location. Such announcements are issued by Human Resources and the Facilities team through corporate email and Slack. Employees should not assume a site closure based on informal information.

11.6 Building Security

Physical security at NexaCore facilities is maintained through biometric turnstiles at the main lobby, mandatory visible display of ID cards, a 24/7 staffed Security Desk, controlled access to server rooms and hardware labs, and mandatory pre-registration of visitors. Employees contribute to building security by tapping their own card every time, refusing to allow tailgating, challenging or reporting unbadged individuals, never sharing an access card, and reporting a lost card immediately so it can be deactivated.

11.7 Visitor Emergencies

Hosts are accountable for their visitors from check-in to check-out, and that accountability extends fully into an emergency. If a visitor is taken ill, the host must contact the Medical Room and Security Desk immediately and remain with the visitor. During an evacuation, the host must guide the visitor to the North Lawn assembly point and confirm their presence at the roll call, because visitors do not appear on employee attendance records and are otherwise invisible to the roll call process. Visitors must never be left unattended beyond the lobby at any time, and this rule applies with particular force during an emergency.

12. Company Culture

NexaCore culture is the daily expression of the four core values. This section describes what those values look like in practice, with realistic examples drawn from how NexaCore teams actually work across Bengaluru, Patiala, Pune and Hyderabad.

12.1 Innovation

Innovation at NexaCore is incremental and evidence-led rather than performative. It comes from engineers who notice a repeated manual step and automate it, from product managers who challenge a requirement that no longer serves the client, and from researchers in the Southern R&D Center who test an approach, measure it honestly, and discard it when the data does not support it.

EXAMPLE: A QA & Automation engineer at the Northern Regional Hub in Patiala notices that a regression suite is re-run manually after every hotfix, consuming several hours each week across the team. She uses her Udemy for Business access to complete a CI/CD module, proposes a pipeline change to her L4 manager, and implements it with DevOps & Site Reliability. The change is documented on Confluence and adopted by two other delivery pods. Her manager records the impact in the March annual review, which contributes to an "Exceeds Expectations" rating.

12.2 Teamwork

NexaCore work is distributed by design, and teamwork here means making that distribution invisible to the client. It means scheduling inside core hours so no one is systematically excluded, documenting decisions on Confluence so colleagues in another city are not dependent on having been in the room, and covering for a colleague on leave without being asked.

EXAMPLE: A backend pod at the Western Delivery Center in Pune and the Document Intelligence Team in Bengaluru share a delivery milestone. Rather than holding separate stand-ups, they run a single 15-minute joint stand-up at 10:15 AM — inside core hours — and maintain one Jira board with a single named owner per ticket. When a Pune engineer takes planned leave, her tickets are reassigned in advance rather than left to stall.

12.3 Recognition

Recognition at NexaCore is specific and timely. Managers are expected to acknowledge good work when it happens rather than saving it for the review cycle, and peer recognition in team channels is actively encouraged. Formal recognition flows through the performance process: sustained impact is reflected in the March annual rating, which drives the April increment and promotion cycle, and in variable pay paid in the October and April payroll cycles.

12.4 Ownership

Every Jira ticket, Confluence page and production service at NexaCore has a single named owner. Ownership means seeing a problem through to resolution rather than routing it onward, escalating early when the outcome is at risk, and taking responsibility for a mistake without deflection.

EXAMPLE: A Site Reliability engineer identifies that a client-facing service will breach its response-time commitment under projected month-end volume. Rather than waiting for the breach, he raises the risk with his L4 manager the same day, proposes two mitigation options with effort estimates, and documents the analysis on Confluence. The early escalation is treated as exactly the behaviour NexaCore wants, not as an admission of failure.

12.5 Integrity

Integrity First is the first NexaCore value, and it is the one with the least tolerance for exceptions. It means submitting accurate expense claims with valid GST receipts; declaring a conflict of interest to the Legal & Compliance Team proactively; never posting client names or code snippets on social media; never sharing an access card or tailgating through a turnstile; and reporting a security mistake immediately even when it is embarrassing to do so.

EXAMPLE: An employee realises shortly after sending an email that it contained a client document and went to an incorrect external address. Rather than hoping it goes unnoticed, he reports it immediately to the IT Security Officer (CISO) as an information breach, and the Legal Team is notified as secondary escalation. Because the report was immediate, containment is possible. NexaCore does not penalise prompt, honest reporting of a genuine mistake — it penalises concealment.

12.6 Customer Centricity

Customer Centricity means designing to the client's operating reality rather than to internal convenience. Practically, it shows up in formal business attire and full preparation for every client meeting regardless of the day of the week; in escalating delivery risk to the client early rather than absorbing it silently until it becomes a crisis; and in the Customer Success team carrying the client's voice into product planning rather than filtering it.

12.7 Agility

Agile Innovation means adapting, iterating and inventing continuously. At NexaCore this shows up as short delivery increments rather than long unvalidated builds, as willingness to challenge an approach constructively even after work has started, and as continuous skill renewal through the certification budget and the learning platforms. Agility is not an excuse for undocumented decisions or unowned work — short cycles make documentation and clear ownership more important, not less.

12.8 Inclusion

Inclusive Excellence means NexaCore actively builds a workplace where diverse perspectives drive superior outcomes.

EXAMPLE: A design review at the Southern R&D Center in Hyderabad includes three participants joining remotely from Patiala. The facilitator sets the meeting at 11:00 AM — inside core hours — posts the design document on Confluence 24 hours in advance so that participants can prepare in their own time, and explicitly invites each remote participant by name for input before the decision is taken. A junior L2 associate raises a concern about an edge case; the concern is documented and addressed rather than deferred because of grade.

Inclusion also has a hard boundary: NexaCore has zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination or retaliation. POSH matters route directly to the Internal Complaints Committee, and retaliation against a complainant or witness is itself a disciplinary offence.

13. Overview of Other Policies

This handbook is the entry point to the NexaCore Knowledge Base. This section introduces the seven companion governance documents, explains what each contains, and directs employees to the controlling document for complete details.

IMPORTANT: The summaries below are provided for orientation only. They do not restate the policies in full. **For any definitive answer, consult the relevant policy document directly on the HRMS (Workday) document library or the NexaCore Knowledge Base on Confluence.**

13.1 Leave Policy

The Leave Policy dictates accrual, application and approval workflows for all time-off categories. It covers Casual Leave, Earned Leave, Sick Leave, Maternity Leave, Paternity Leave and Bereavement Leave; carry-forward and lapse rules; encashment on exit; documentation requirements for extended sick leave; and the approval routing for each leave type. All leave balances are calculated per calendar year, from 1 January to 31 December.

Key facts: Full-Time Employees at L2-L6 receive 12 days Casual Leave, 18 days Earned Leave and 6 days Sick Leave per year. Interns at L1 receive 6 days Casual Leave and 3 days Sick Leave, pro-rated over a standard six-month internship. Contractors at C1 do not accrue leave. Earned Leave carries forward to a maximum of 10 days; Casual and Sick Leave lapse at year-end. Maternity Leave is 26 weeks and Paternity Leave is 2 weeks for Full-Time Employees. Bereavement Leave is 3 days for FTEs and Interns.

Refer to the Leave Policy for complete details. Owned by the Employee Success (HRBP) team.

13.2 Expense and Reimbursement Policy

The Expense & Reimbursement Policy outlines acceptable limits, receipt requirements and claim processes for operational costs. It covers internet and mobile reimbursement, taxi and cab claims, relocation support, certification funding and client meal entertainment, together with the approval routing and audit process for each.

Key facts: All expenses require valid GST receipts unless specified as a flat allowance, and claims must be submitted via the HRMS **within 30 days of the expense**.

Table 13-1: Expense and Reimbursement Limits Summary

Expense Category	L1 & C1	L2 & L3	L4 & Above	Notes
Internet (WFH)	₹0	₹1,000 / month	₹1,000 / month	Bill must be in the employee's name.
Mobile Phone	₹0	₹500 / month	₹1,500 / month	Requires manager approval for L2.
Taxi / Cab	Actuals	₹2,500 / trip limit	Actuals	For late work (after 8 PM) or airport transit.
Relocation	₹0	Up to ₹30,000	Up to ₹75,000	Valid for company-requested moves over 100 km.
Certifications	₹0	₹25,000 / year	₹50,000 / year	Must be pre-approved by L4+ and relevant to role.
Client Meals	₹0	₹1,500 / person	₹3,000 / person	Requires itemised receipt; alcohol strictly excluded.

Refer to the Expense & Reimbursement Policy for complete details. Owned by Siddharth Kapoor, Director of Finance.

13.3 Employee Benefits Guide

The Employee Benefits Guide details health insurance, wellness programmes and retirement benefits. It covers enrolment and nomination procedures, the claim and cashless hospitalisation process, network hospital access, dependent addition windows, and the wellness programmes available across all four office locations.

Key facts: Insurance is available only to Full-Time Employees at grades L2-L6. **Interns and Contractors are not covered under corporate health plans**, although they retain full access to the on-site Medical Room and emergency support.

Table 13-2: Insurance Benefits Summary (Full-Time Employees, L2-L6 only)

Benefit Type	Coverage Amount	Dependents Covered	Co-Pay Rules
Group Medical Cover (GMC)	₹5,00,000	Spouse, up to 2 Children	0% Co-pay
Parental GMC Add-on	₹3,00,000	Parents / Parents-in-law	20% Co-pay on all claims
Group Term Life (GTL)	3x Annual CTC	Not applicable — nominee receives payout	Not applicable
Accidental (GPA)	₹10,00,000	Employee Only	Not applicable

Refer to the Employee Benefits Guide for complete details. Owned by the Payroll & Benefits team.

13.4 Travel Policy

The Travel Policy governs domestic and international travel approvals, hotel categories and per diem rates. It covers the travel request workflow, booking procedures through the approved travel desk, visa support, travel insurance, advance requests and post-travel expense settlement.

Key facts: Travel requests must be raised **14 days in advance for international travel** and **7 days in advance for domestic travel**.

Table 13-3: Travel Entitlements Summary

Rule Category	Domestic Travel (India)	International Travel
Approval Required	L4 (Manager)	L5 (Director)

Flight Class	Economy for all grades	Economy (L2-L4) / Business (L5-L6)
Hotel Limit (L2 / L3)	₹4,000 per night (3-Star)	\$150 per night
Hotel Limit (L4+)	₹7,500 per night (4-Star / 5-Star)	\$250 per night
Per Diem (Food / Incidental)	₹1,000 per day	\$50 per day

Refer to the **Travel Policy** for complete details. Owned by Siddharth Kapoor, Director of Finance.

13.5 Remote Work Policy

The Remote Work Policy establishes eligibility, equipment allowances and security expectations for work-from-home and hybrid schedules. It covers the approval workflow for a hybrid schedule, expectations for availability and responsiveness, ergonomic guidance, and the information security requirements that apply when working outside a NexaCore office.

Key facts: Employees at **L2 and above are eligible for hybrid work after completing their 6-month probation period**, and may work from home **up to 2 days per week** (typically 3 days in office, 2 days from home). **Interns at L1 must work 100% from the office** unless explicitly approved by an L5 Director for exceptional circumstances. A one-time **WFH Setup Allowance of ₹15,000** is provided to Full-Time Employees at L2 and above to purchase an ergonomic chair and desk, and **must be claimed within the first 6 months of employment**.

SECURITY WHILE WORKING FROM HOME: Employees must prevent shoulder-surfing, use a secured private Wi-Fi network, never use public cafe or airport Wi-Fi without the VPN active, and lock their screen whenever they step away from the device.

Refer to the **Remote Work Policy** for complete details. Owned by the Employee Success (HRBP) team.

13.6 Code of Conduct

The Code of Conduct defines ethical expectations, conflict of interest, anti-harassment (POSH) and disciplinary procedures. It covers the standards of business conduct expected of every employee, the process for declaring and managing conflicts of interest, gift and hospitality rules, anti-bribery provisions, the POSH framework and the constitution and procedures of the Internal Complaints Committee, and the formal disciplinary process including warnings, investigations and grounds for termination.

Key facts: POSH matters are reported directly to the **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)**, with secondary escalation to Legal & Compliance and the CHRO. Conflict of interest matters are reported to the Legal & Compliance Team, with secondary escalation to the CHRO. Retaliation against a complainant or witness is a disciplinary offence.

Refer to the **Code of Conduct** for complete details. Owned by the Legal & Compliance Team.

13.7 Information Security Policy

The Information Security Policy mandates data protection, asset management, network security and compliance protocols. It covers acceptable use of company hardware and networks, data classification and handling, access control, incident reporting, third-party and client data obligations, and audit requirements.

Key facts:

- **Hardware:** Employees must only use company-issued laptops. Loss of a laptop must be reported to IT Support **within 4 hours**. An employee may be liable for **20% of the depreciated cost** if the loss results from gross negligence.
- **USB drives:** The use of personal USB drives or external hard drives is **strictly prohibited**. USB ports are restricted via MDM software.
- **Software installation:** Employees cannot install unapproved software. Administrative rights are locked. Requests must be routed via IT Service Desk tickets.
- **Passwords:** Minimum **14 characters**, alphanumeric with special characters, with mandatory rotation every **90 days**.
- **VPN:** Mandatory for accessing internal staging servers, the HRMS and the codebase when outside the office network.
- **Social media:** Confidential company data, code snippets and client names must never be posted on social media.

Refer to the **Information Security Policy** for complete details. Owned by Ananya Rao, Chief Information Security Officer.

13.8 Document Reference Summary

Table 13-4: Where to Find the Definitive Answer

If your question is about...	Consult	Document Owner
Leave entitlement, accrual, carry-forward, encashment	Leave Policy	Employee Success (HRBP)
Expense limits, receipts, reimbursement claims	Expense & Reimbursement Policy	Siddharth Kapoor
Insurance, wellness, retirement benefits	Employee Benefits Guide	Payroll & Benefits
Flights, hotels, per diem, travel approval	Travel Policy	Siddharth Kapoor
Hybrid eligibility, WFH allowance, remote security	Remote Work Policy	Employee Success (HRBP)
Ethics, conflict of interest, POSH, discipline	Code of Conduct	Legal & Compliance Team
Passwords, devices, data handling, breaches	Information Security Policy	Ananya Rao, CISO
Working hours, attendance, dress code, facilities, conduct norms	This Employee Handbook	Ritika Sharma, CHRO

14. Frequently Asked Questions

The following questions are the ones most frequently raised with the Employee Success (HRBP) team, the IT Service Desk and the Facilities team. Each answer identifies the correct system or contact and, where relevant, cross-references the controlling policy document.

14.1 Leave, Attendance and Working Hours

Q1. Where do I apply for leave?

All leave is applied for in the **HRMS (Workday)** and approved by your reporting manager. Email, Slack and verbal requests are not valid leave applications. Full entitlement, accrual and carry-forward rules are in the **Leave Policy**.

Q2. How many leave days do I get each year?

Full-Time Employees at grades L2-L6 receive **12 days Casual Leave, 18 days Earned Leave and 6 days Sick Leave** per calendar year. Interns at L1 receive **6 days Casual Leave and 3 days Sick Leave**, pro-rated over a standard six-month internship. Contractors at C1 do not accrue leave. The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**.

Q3. Which leaves carry forward to next year?

Only **Earned Leave** carries forward, up to a maximum of **10 days**. Casual Leave and Sick Leave **lapse at year-end**. Maternity Leave cannot be carried forward, and Paternity Leave lapses 6 months after the birth.

Q4. What happens if I swipe in after 10:30 AM?

Swiping in after 10:30 AM **without prior flexi-hour approval** automatically deducts **0.5 Casual Leave**. If your Casual Leave balance is exhausted, the deduction is taken from Earned Leave. This is applied automatically by the HRMS. If the record is genuinely incorrect, raise an Attendance Correction within 7 days (see Q6).

Q5. Can I set my own working hours?

Yes. You may set your own **9-hour schedule** provided you are present for the full core hours of **10:00 AM to 04:00 PM**. The flexi-hour schedule must be approved by your manager in the HRMS **before** it takes effect — it cannot be applied retrospectively to excuse a late swipe.

Q6. My attendance record is wrong. How do I fix it?

Raise an **Attendance Correction request in the HRMS** against the affected date, select the reason (card malfunction, client visit, missed exit tap, approved off-site work), add a short explanation and any supporting evidence, and submit it to your reporting manager. Requests must be raised **within 7 calendar days** of the affected date.

Q7. What counts as a half-day?

Working **fewer than 4.5 hours** in a calendar day is recorded as a half-day. You should apply for half-day leave in the HRMS for the remaining portion.

Q8. How many public holidays do we get, and how does the floating holiday work?

Employees receive **10 paid public holidays** per calendar year. Nine are fixed dates published in the 2026 Holiday Calendar (Table 5-3). The tenth is a **floating holiday of the employee's choice**, which is not granted automatically — it **must be applied for as Earned Leave via the HRMS** and approved by your manager.

14.2 Payroll, Tax and Benefits

Q9. When is salary credited?

Salary is credited on the **last working day of every month**. Payslips are available for download from the HRMS.

Q10. When is variable pay or bonus paid?

Variable pay is paid **bi-annually, in the October and April payroll cycles**, prorated based on your individual performance rating.

Q11. How much Provident Fund is deducted?

12% of Basic Salary is deducted as the employee contribution, with an equal matching contribution from the company.

Q12. When am I eligible for gratuity?

Gratuity is calculated at **15 days of basic salary for every completed year of service** and is payable only after completing **5 continuous years** of employment.

Q13. When can I submit my tax declaration proofs?

The IT declaration window is open on the HRMS from **1 January to 15 February** for rent receipts, 80C and 80D proofs. Proofs submitted after 15 February cannot be processed in the same financial year and may result in higher tax deducted at source.

Q14. What health insurance do I get, and are my parents covered?

Full-Time Employees at L2-L6 receive **Group Medical Cover of ₹5,00,000** covering spouse and up to 2 children at **0% co-pay**. A **Parental GMC Add-on of ₹3,00,000** covers parents or parents-in-law with a **20% co-pay on all claims**. Group Term Life provides **3x Annual CTC** to your nominee, and Group Personal Accident cover is **₹10,00,000** for the employee only. **Interns and contractors are not covered under corporate health plans**. See the **Employee Benefits Guide**.

14.3 IT, Assets and Access

Q15. Who do I contact if my laptop is lost or stolen?

Report it to **IT Support within 4 hours** via an IT Service Desk ticket. A **police FIR** is required before a replacement laptop is issued. If the loss resulted from gross negligence, you may be liable for **20% of the depreciated cost**. See the **Information Security Policy**.

Q16. How do I report an IT issue?

Raise a ticket with the **IT Service Desk**. This is the single route for hardware faults, software requests, access provisioning, VPN problems and account lockouts. Please do not contact individual IT staff directly — tickets ensure your request is tracked and prioritised.

Q17. Can I install software on my company laptop?

No. **Administrative rights are locked** and unapproved software cannot be installed. Raise an **IT Service Desk ticket** to request any software you need for your role.

Q18. Can I use a personal USB drive to transfer files?

No. The use of **personal USB drives or external hard drives is strictly prohibited**, and USB ports are restricted via MDM software. Use the approved shared drives and collaboration tools instead.

Q19. When will my laptop be replaced?

Refresh cycles are **3 years** for standard laptops, **2.5 years** for the AI / Document Intelligence Team's high-specification machines, **5 years** for office monitors and **1 year** for peripherals such as mice and keyboards. Intern laptops are returned at the end of the internship term. See Tables 9-3 and 9-4.

Q20. Do I need to use the VPN?

Yes. The VPN is **mandatory** for accessing internal staging servers, the HRMS and the codebase whenever you are outside the office network.

Never use public Wi-Fi in a cafe, airport or hotel without the VPN active.

14.4 Facilities, Access and Office Life

Q21. How do I replace my ID card?

Report the loss immediately to the **Security Desk** so the card can be deactivated, and raise a replacement request with the **Facilities team**. **Replacement costs ₹500, deducted from payroll**. The Security Desk can issue a temporary day pass in the meantime.

Q22. Where is the medical room?

At the Global Headquarters (TechPark One, Bengaluru), the Medical Room is on the **Ground Floor, East Wing**, and is staffed by a **registered nurse 24/7**.

Q23. How do I book a meeting room?

Meeting rooms are booked through the calendar system linked to your corporate email. Book only the capacity you need, release the booking if the meeting is cancelled, and schedule cross-team meetings inside core hours (10:00 AM to 04:00 PM). Client-facing rooms near Reception must be booked at least **24 hours in advance**.

Q24. Where do I park?

At TechPark One: **Basement 1** is reserved for grades **L4 and above**; **Basement 2** is general car parking for grades **L1 to L3**; and **Basement 3** is two-wheeler parking for everyone. A valid NexaCore parking sticker from the Facilities team is required.

Q25. How do I bring a visitor into the office?

Pre-register your visitor via the **Envoy app at least 24 hours in advance**. They check in at Reception with photo ID and receive a visitor badge. **You must escort your visitor at all times beyond the lobby** — visitors must never be left unattended.

Q26. Can I use the gym, and what do I need to do first?

The gymnasium is on the **2nd Floor** and is free for Full-Time Employees. You must sign a **safety waiver** with the Facilities team before your first use, and wear appropriate athletic footwear.

Q27. What should I wear to work?

Smart Casuals Monday to Thursday, **Casuals** on Friday. **Formal business attire** is required for client meetings and interview panels, whatever the day. Hackathons are relaxed casual and hoodies are allowed. **Open-toe shoes, flip-flops and shorts are strictly prohibited in server rooms and hardware labs at all times**.

14.5 Learning, Performance and Career

Q28. How do I access LinkedIn Learning and Udemy for Business?

All employees at **every grade, L1 through L6, including contractors**, receive enterprise access to both platforms. Sign in through the **internal portal** using single sign-on with your corporate email. No approval or cost recovery is required.

Q29. Will the company pay for my certification?

Yes, within the annual certification budget: **₹25,000 per year for L2 and L3** and **₹50,000 per year for L4 and above**. The certification **must be pre-approved by an L4 or above** and must be relevant to your role. Interns (L1) and Contractors (C1) are not eligible. Claims must be submitted within 30 days with a valid receipt.

Q30. Can I attend a technology conference?

Employees at **L3 and above** are eligible for **one company-sponsored domestic technology conference per year**, such as AWS Summit or Google Cloud Next. Approval is routed via the **VP of Engineering, Rohan Gupta**. Domestic travel rules apply, so raise the travel request at least 7 days in advance.

Q31. When do performance reviews happen?

There are two cycles: the **Mid-Year Review in October** (developmental focus, no compensation changes) and the **Annual Review in March** (ratings locked, influences April increments).

Q32. What do I need for a promotion?

Three things simultaneously: a minimum of **18 months in your current grade**, a minimum annual rating of **"4 - Exceeds Expectations"**, and a **direct manager recommendation (L4+) plus HR Business Partner approval**. Promotions are effective **1 April** each year. Grade-specific tenure and certification requirements are in Table 3-3.

14.6 Remote Work and Hybrid

Q33. Can I work from home?

Employees at **L2 and above** are eligible for hybrid work **after completing the 6-month probation period**, and may work from home **up to 2 days per week** (typically 3 days in office, 2 days from home). See the **Remote Work Policy**.

Q34. Can interns work from home?

No. **Interns (L1) must work 100% from the office**, unless explicitly approved by an **L5 Director** for exceptional circumstances.

Q35. What is the WFH setup allowance and when must I claim it?

A **one-time allowance of ₹15,000** is provided to Full-Time Employees at L2 and above to purchase an ergonomic chair and desk. It **must be claimed within the first 6 months of employment**. Interns and contractors are not eligible.

Q36. Can I claim my home internet and mobile bills?

Yes, if you are L2 or above. **Internet: ₹1,000 per month** for L2 and above — the bill must be in your own name. **Mobile: ₹500 per month for L2 and L3, ₹1,500 per month for L4 and above** (L2 requires manager approval). Interns and contractors are not eligible. Claims go through the HRMS within 30 days with valid GST receipts.

14.7 Conduct, Escalation and Support

Q37. How do I report harassment?

Report it directly to the **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)**, with secondary escalation to the **Legal & Compliance Team and the CHRO**. **You do not need to raise it with your manager first**. Retaliation against a complainant or a witness is itself a disciplinary offence. See the **Code of Conduct**.

Q38. Who do I go to with a general workplace grievance?

Your **direct manager (L4 or above)** is the first point of contact, with secondary escalation to your **HR Business Partner**. Conflict of interest goes to Legal & Compliance; information breaches go to the CISO. See the Escalation Matrix in Table 10-3.

Q39. I clicked a phishing link or sent data to the wrong recipient. What now?

Report it **immediately** to the **IT Security Officer (CISO), Ananya Rao**, with secondary escalation to the Legal Team. Prompt reporting makes containment possible. NexaCore does not penalise honest, immediate reporting of a genuine mistake — concealment is what is treated as a serious offence.

14.8 Joining and Exit

Q40. What happens on my first day?

Induction begins at **09:00 AM at the Global Headquarters, TechPark One, Bengaluru**, for all new joiners regardless of base location. **IT asset handover is at 11:30 AM**, and your **ID card is issued on Day 1**. The afternoon is spent with your reporting manager and assigned buddy.

Q41. How long does background verification take, and what if there is a discrepancy?

BGV is managed by **HireRight** and **must be completed within 30 days of joining**. Respond promptly to HireRight requests. **Discrepancies may result in immediate termination**, so ensure everything you declared is accurate and verifiable.

Q42. How long is my probation, and what changes when I am confirmed?

Probation is **6 months** for Full-Time Employees. On confirmation you become eligible for the hybrid work schedule, and your tenure clock for promotion eligibility begins.

Q43. What is my notice period?

60 days for Full-Time Employees at L2 and above, **15 days** for Interns at L1, and **30 days** for Contractors at C1. Resignation must be submitted **via the HRMS** — an email or verbal resignation does not start the notice period.

Q44. When do I have to return my laptop and other assets?

All assets must be surrendered to the **IT Service Desk by 4:00 PM on your Last Working Day (LWD)**. Unreturned assets are recovered from your Full and Final Settlement at depreciated replacement value, and asset clearance is a prerequisite for both F&F release and your Experience Letter.

Q45. When will I receive my experience letter?

The Experience Letter is **generated automatically 45 days after your Full and Final Settlement is completed**. You do not need to raise a request. It is sent to your registered personal email address and is also downloadable from the HRMS.

Q46. How do I request an employment verification letter while I am still employed?

Raise a **"Letter Request" ticket in the HRMS**. The Employee Success (HRBP) team issues employment verification letters for visa applications, loan processing and rental agreements.

Q47. Can I apply for another role inside NexaCore?

Yes, through the **Internal Job Posting (IJP)** board in the HRMS. You must have completed probation, spent a minimum of **12 months in your current role**, and hold a rating of **"Meets Expectations" or above**. Applications are confidential until the interview stage, at which point your current manager is informed.

Q48. Where do I find the full policy documents?

All eight core governance documents are published in the **HRMS (Workday) document library** and mirrored on the **NexaCore Knowledge Base on Confluence**, both reachable through the internal portal. See Table 13-4 for which document answers which question.

Employee Acknowledgement

Every employee, intern and contractor is required to acknowledge receipt and reading of the NexaCore Technologies Employee Handbook. The acknowledgement is recorded electronically in the HRMS (Workday) as part of the onboarding learning path and must be completed **within the first 30 days of joining**. Existing employees re-acknowledge the handbook at each major version release.

Acknowledgement Statement

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the NexaCore Technologies Employee Handbook, Version 4.0 (Document Number NCT-HR-HB-004), effective 1 April 2026.

I understand that this handbook describes the operational rules of the company and signposts the seven companion governance documents — the Leave Policy, the Expense & Reimbursement Policy, the Information Security Policy, the Employee Benefits Guide, the Remote Work Policy, the Code of Conduct and the Travel Policy — and that where this handbook and a companion policy differ, the companion policy prevails.

I understand that this handbook is confidential and proprietary to NexaCore Technologies and must not be shared outside the company.

I understand that NexaCore Technologies may revise this handbook, and that the version published on the HRMS is the only authoritative version.

Table 15-1: Acknowledgement Record (Completed in the HRMS)

Field	Entry
Employee Name	
Employee ID	
Job Grade (L1-L6 / C1)	
Department	
Base Location (Bengaluru / Patiala / Pune / Hyderabad)	
Reporting Manager	
Date of Acknowledgement	
Handbook Version Acknowledged	Version 4.0 (NCT-HR-HB-004)

Document Closure

Table 15-2: Document Control Summary

Attribute	Value
Document Name	Employee Handbook
Document Number	NCT-HR-HB-004
Version	4.0
Effective Date	01 April 2026
Next Review Date	31 March 2027
Document Owner	Ritika Sharma, Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)
Prepared By	Employee Success (HRBP) Team, Human Resources
Approved By	Arjun Mehta, Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
Classification	Internal — Confidential
Distribution	All employees, interns and contractors of NexaCore Technologies
Retention	Retained in the HRMS (Workday) document library and the NexaCore Knowledge Base on Confluence

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